

the hindu businessline.

bl.portfolio



Chart check.
US-Iran war:
What lies ahead
for oil, gold,
dollar and rupee?
BIG STORY P2



Women's Day.
Her money,
her rules, her
investment
journey
YOUR MONEY P9

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

‘US trade deal under review; to take 3-4 more months’

TAXING. India to keep close watch on whether the Trump administration uses other provisions to circumvent SC ruling

Poornima Joshi
New Delhi

The March deadline for the India-US trade deal will be set aside and it may take another three-four months to reassess the situation and conclude the deal after the US Supreme Court struck down the tariffs imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA), a senior

government source has said. The official said the court's decision has paused the talks but India will keep a keen eye on what tools are employed by the US administration to impose additional tariffs. "...If they use another provision, we will assess whether the deal still makes sense. It will take three-four months," the source said.

CLAUSE 8 TRIGGERED According to the official, the



ruling has effectively triggered Clause 8 of the Indo-US joint statement that categorically states that should the circum-

stances change, the deal would be reworked to make sure that the balance is maintained on both sides. "Trade deals are about preferential treatment. Once tariffs were declared illegal, we had the opportunity to rework the deal," the source added.

The official emphasised that India does not want an antagonistic trade situation with the US, describing the American economy as a "\$30-trillion

market" and a critical partner.

According to the source, the US has at least four alternative legal avenues to impose tariffs. These include Section 122 of the US Trade Act of 1974, which allows tariffs of up to 15 per cent for 150 days. Section 232 of the US Trade Expansion Act permits country- or product-specific tariffs ranging from 50 to even 100 per cent. There is also Section 338 of the Smoot-Hawley Tariff Act of 1930,

though it has never been used by the US. The most powerful tool is Section 301 of the US Trade Act, which allows Washington to investigate unfair trade practices and impose tariffs on entire sectors or countries.

Washington's tariff strategy will also be shaped by domestic economic considerations, including efforts by the Trump administration to avoid fuelling inflation.

INVESTMENT FOCUS.

Bandhan Large Cap Fund: Invest

Venkatasubramanian K
bl. research bureau

In the current volatile environment, relatively safer approach for long-term investors would be to buy large-cap funds. Bandhan Large Cap fund can be a good addition to investors with a seven-year or higher perspective via the SIP route.

When five-year rolling returns are taken from

January 2018 to February 2026, the fund has outperformed the Nifty 100 TRI over 76 per cent of the time. The mean return for the fund is 16.8 per cent, while for the Nifty 100 TRI, it is 16.1 per cent.

Over this rolling period and timeframe, it has delivered more than 12 per cent of the time and in excess of 15 per cent for over 68 per cent of the time.

Govt hikes LPG prices a day after invoking emergency powers to boost output

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Union government on Saturday raised the price of cooking gas by ₹60 per cylinder for both PMUY and non-PMUY users as the world's third largest liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) consumer navigates a complex scenario of rising prices coupled with lack of cargoes from its main suppliers in West Asia, a region caught in a full blown war.

The price hike — second in the current financial year — comes at a time as Delhi scrambles to secure cargoes from the US and Canada, while invoking emergency powers to direct refiners to maximise production of the critical cooking fuel used by more than 33 crore consumers, including over 10 crore PM Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) beneficiaries.

Effective Saturday, non-PMUY consumers will have to shell out ₹913 for a 14.2-kg cylinder in Delhi. PMUY consumers will have to pay ₹613 per cylinder.

Breaking down the ₹60 per cylinder price hike for both PMUY and non-PMUY consumers, a top source said it translates to roughly 80 paise per family per day for cooking, or around 20 paise per person per day (for a family of four).

The government also raised the price of commercial LPG by ₹114.5 per 19-kg cylinder to ₹1,883 in Delhi.



HALT AT HORMUZ

Government sources said the price rise reflects the conflict in West Asia, which led to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

India consumed more than 33 million tonnes of LPG in FY25, of which over half was imported. Of the imports, 85-90 per cent came from West Asia with most cargoes transiting via the Strait of Hormuz.

Middle East Gulf (MEG), excluding Iran, is India's largest supplier of LPG, covering 92 per cent (around 720,000 barrels per day) of imports as of 2025, per Vortexa.

The government is exploring all possible sources to get fresh supplies, some of which are expected by this month end.

Besides buying 10 per cent of its LPG requirement from the US, India is also in touch with Canada to procure LPG. Africa is another region that India can look at for additional cargoes.

Iran's President defies US surrender demand; apologises to neighbours for strikes

AP- PTI
Dubai

Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian said on Saturday that a demand by the US for an unconditional surrender is a "dream that they should take to their grave." Pezeshkian made the statement in a pre-recorded address aired by the state television.

He also apologised for Iran's attacks on regional countries, insisting that Tehran would halt them and suggesting they were caused by miscommunication in the ranks.

The comments came as intense Iranian fire targeted Bahrain, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates on Saturday morning even as Israel and the US kept up their airstrikes at the Islamic Republic.

There was no foreseeable end to the fighting. US President Donald Trump's administration approved a new \$151-million arms sale to Israel after Trump said he would not negotiate with Iran without its "unconditional

surrender", and US officials warned of a bombing campaign they said would be the most intense yet.

Iran's UN ambassador said the country would "take all measures" to defend itself.

The US and Israel have battered Iran with strikes, targeting its military capabilities, leadership and nuclear programme. The stated goals and timelines for the war have repeatedly shifted, as the US has at times suggested it seeks to topple Iran's government or elevate new leadership from within.

RUSSIA HELP?

Russia has provided Iran with information that could help Tehran strike American warships, aircraft and other assets in the region, according to two officials familiar with US intelligence on the matter. They cautioned that the US intelligence has not uncovered that Russia is directing Iran on what to do with the information. Still, it's the first indication that Moscow has sought to get involved in the war.



भारतीय जीवन बीमा निगम
LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION OF INDIA

Har Pal Aapke Saath



GROUNDED, YET TOUCHES THE SKY

LIC
WISHES EVERY
WOMAN

A VERY HAPPY INTERNATIONAL
Women's
DAY.

8TH MARCH

Our WhatsApp No.
8976862090

Say 'Hi'

Download
LIC Mobile App

Visit: licindia.in

Call Centre Services
(022) 6827 6827

Follow us: [f](#) [y](#) [x](#) [i](#) [in](#) LIC India Forever | IRDAI Regn No.: 512

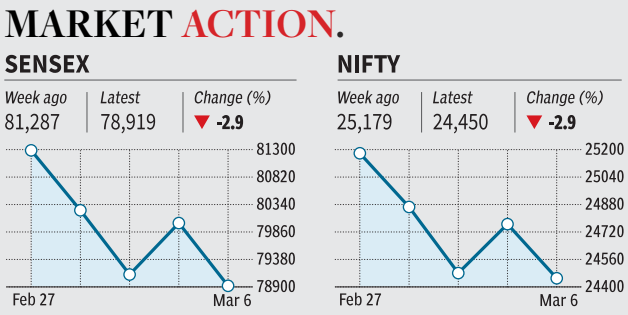
LIC / P1 / 2025-26 / 35 / Eng

bl.portfolio

WISE WORDS.

“When you look at the chart of a stock or the market, to me it expresses what all the investors think about the company or market.”

STEVE EISMAN
One of the ‘Big Short’ investors



Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The US attacking Iran on March 7 rattled the global financial markets last week. Crude Oil price surged about 28 per cent. Brent Crude oil touched a high of \$94.65 per barrel during the week. It closed the week at \$92.70 per barrel.

On the other hand, the global equity markets were knocked down badly initially. However, some markets managed to recoup some of the loss in the second half.

In the US, the Dow Jones Industrial Average and the S&P 500 index were down 3 per cent and 2 per cent respectively for the week.

Gold remained volatile. Surprisingly it has not gained much sheen at this time of huge uncertainty. The yellow metal price went up 2.7 per cent initially, but then fell giving back all the gains. Indeed, it closed the week down by 2.7 per cent.

Dollar index has gained about 1.2 per cent for the week. It was up just over 2 per cent intra week. Looking at this, it clearly shows that the dollar index is gaining more of the safe-haven status this time compared to gold. The reason could merely be because gold price has already surged a lot.

On the domestic front, the Indian benchmark indices, the Nifty 50 and Sensex fell about 3.5 per cent each during the week. They recovered from the lows and ended the week down by about 2.9 per cent each.

The Indian rupee fell 1.4 per cent and marked a new low of 92.30 against the dol-

US-IRAN WAR. What next for Oil, Gold, Dollar and Rupee

CHART CHECK. Using technical analysis, we assess how major asset classes may respond in the days ahead, as geopolitical tensions unsettle sentiment and reshape global risk appetite

lar last week. The domestic currency closed the week at 91.75, down 0.84 per cent.

WHAT NEXT?

The big question now is where the market is headed from here. Will the war disrupt the oil supply? How long can this war go on? Will the situation worsen further with other countries getting pulled into the fight? These are some of the questions for which we do not have a concrete answer as of now.

That makes the situation more complex and unpredictable.

So, we keep all these questions aside without attempting to find an answer.

However, we take a different approach to forecast where the market is headed by analysing the historical price movement alone using charts and technical analysis. Many may argue that forecasting using charts at times of high uncertainty may not work. *Known fundamentals are already discounted, and the price reacts to unknown fundamentals.* Technical analysis works under this premise.

So, here is our analysis and forecast on Brent Crude Oil, Dollar Index, Gold and Indian Rupee based on charts.

To know where the domestic equity indices (Sensex, Nifty 50, Bank Nifty) are headed, please read our ‘Index Outlook’ column on Chart-Gazing page of this edition.

Brent Crude: More upside

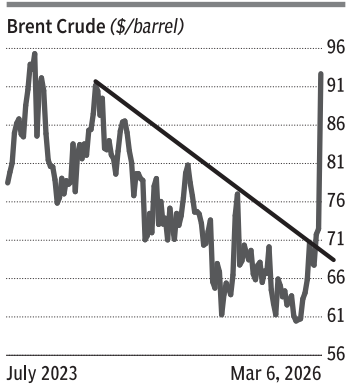
Brent Crude Oil (\$92.70 per barrel) has clearly made a bullish breakout on the charts. The price has been trading inside a bear channel since end-September 2023. Additionally, this breakout has happened after forming a double-bottom pattern. This is a bullish reversal pattern.

The recent surge also indicates that the long-term downtrend that has been in place since mid-2022 has come to an end. The neckline support of the double-bottom pattern is coming around 79. On the other hand, the channel support (resistance-turned-support) will come in the 74.50-73 region.

Our preferred move would be to see \$98-\$99 now. Then see a correction to \$90 and then surge to \$108.

The price has to fall below \$89.2 in order to see \$84 or \$80 on the downside. Only then the chances of a rally above \$100 will reduce. But that is unlikely as long as the US-Iran war continues.

Take away: Be prepared for higher oil price and high inflation.



Dollar Index: Ready for a bullish trend reversal

Barring the fall to a low of 95.55 in January this year, the dollar index (98.85) has been broadly range bound between 96 and 100.40 since June 2025.

For now, 97.60 can be a strong immediate support. Crucial resistances to watch are 100.40 and 101.30.

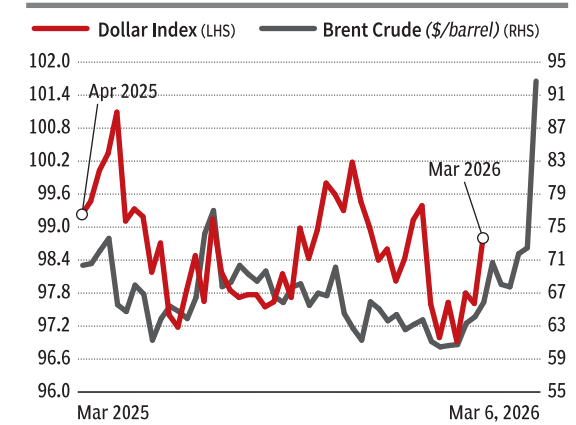
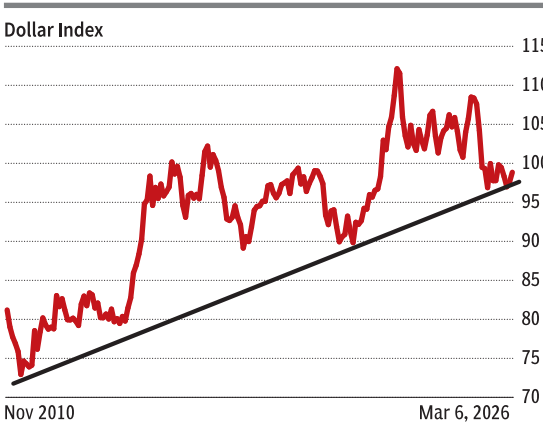
A monthly close above 100.50 will be an initial sign of the bulls gaining strength. A subsequent rise above 101.30 will then boost the bullish momentum.

That in turn can take the dollar index higher to 103 initially. Such a rise will mark the end of the downtrend and indicate that a fresh leg of up-move has begun.

This upmove will have the potential to take the dollar index up to 105-106 this year.

Ideally, a break below 95.50 and a subsequent fall below 95 is needed to negate the above-mentioned bullish view. For that to happen, the dollar index has to sustain below 101.30.

For now, the sideways range is intact. A bullish breakout of this range



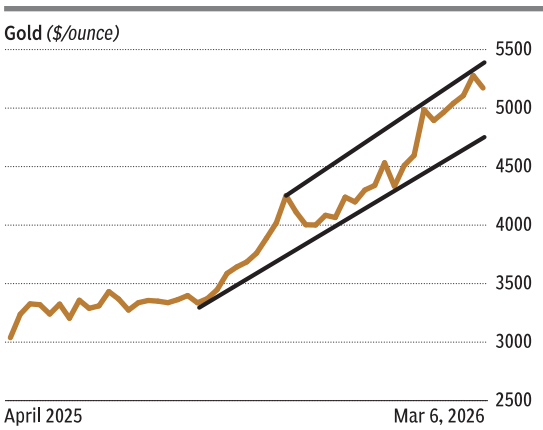
Gold: Taking a back seat among safe havens

Gold (\$5,172 per ounce) price went up initially last week. However, the price has come down after making a high of about \$5,420. Strong supports are at \$5,000 and \$4,800. There is no danger for the broader uptrend as long as the price stays above \$4,800. A rise to \$5,600 is possible again. From a big picture perspective, if the momentum gains, then \$5,900-6,000 can also be seen.

However, looking at the price action on the daily candles since February, it looks like the yellow metal is losing strength. As such, the chances of the upside being capped at \$5,600 cannot be ruled out. So, one possibility is that gold can remain higher but in a wide range of \$5,000-5,600 or \$4,800-5,600 rather than going up to \$5,900-6,000.

This will mean that the dollar can be a more preferred safe-haven option this time. This could also be because gold price has already soared a lot, whereas the dollar index is at the bottom of a downtrend.

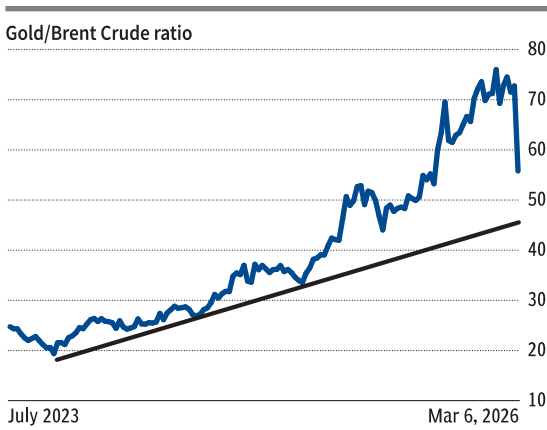
The uptrend in gold will come under threat if the price declines below \$4,800. Such a move will indicate that a top is in place and will drag the price



down to \$4,500.

GOLD/BRENT RATIO (55.80)

In order to get clarity on where the gold price is headed, we analysed the gold/Brent crude ratio. This ratio is obtained by dividing the price of gold by Brent crude. Ratios help us identify which among the two elements taken will outperform. For instance, if the gold/Brent ratio goes up, it means, gold is outperforming oil and vice-versa.



It also helps in forecasting. If we have the forecast for the ratio (gold/Brent) and any one of the elements (say Brent), then we can calculate where the third (gold) is headed. Using this concept, we attempt here to see where gold price is headed.

The recent price action in this ratio confirms a top and a bearish trend reversal. Resistances for the ratio are at 57.30 and 60. The ratio can fall to 53 initially. Any bounce there after will be capped. Eventually, there is room

for the ratio to see 48 or even 46 on the downside from here.

A rise to 108 on Brent Crude and a fall to 48 or 46 on the gold/crude ratio will give us a range of about \$4,970-5,185 for gold. So, if this view works out well, then gold price may not go above \$5,600. Instead, it can remain in a range.

Take away: This may not be the right time to buy gold afresh as the safe-haven sentiment seems to be switching.

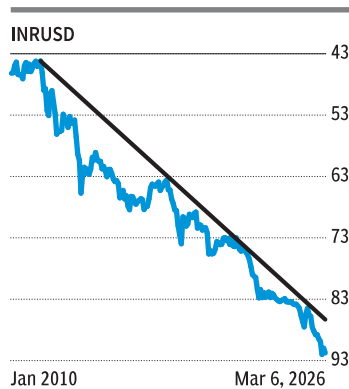
Rupee: Double whammy

High crude oil price and a strong dollar could be a double whammy for the Indian Rupee. High oil price increases the risk of India's trade deficit widening in the coming months. The trade deficit is at \$34.68 billion as of January. This could widen to \$40 billion or even more than that. This will have an impact on India's Current Account Deficit (CAD) as well. The CAD is at \$13.2 billion in the October-December quarter of the fiscal year 2026. This is 1.3 per cent of GDP. There is a danger of the CAD widening further.

Widening deficit coupled with a strong dollar can drag the rupee lower against the greenback.

On the charts, there is a strong resistance for the rupee at 90.50 and 90. The rupee is currently at 91.75. The current movement is in the form of a bear channel, as seen from the weekly chart. This channel resistance is coming around 91. As long as the rupee stays below 91, it can fall to 93-93.10 in the coming weeks.

If it manages to recover from around 93, then a rise back to 92-91



is a possibility. Such a recovery is also possible if the central bank intervenes around 93. In that case, 91-93 (narrow) or 90-93 (wide) can be the trading range for some time.

However, from a long-term perspective, rupee is unlikely to go above 90. The downside remains open to see 96.50-96.70. The pace and the time taken for this fall will depend on how much the central bank intervenes.

Take away: Weak rupee will make your overseas travel, education etc costlier, going forward.

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

Well over \$2.5 trillion in investor wealth has been wiped out over the past week if one considers the major global indices alone. Wars are destructive, yet some pundits might sell the case today that wars are good for the economy and stock markets—as in the case of how the second world war helped the US drag itself out of an economic slump after the great depression.

But not all wars are the same and at this juncture, nobody knows how the ongoing US-Iran war will play out. That said, can investors take cues from past wars and take portfolio decisions? We say, “No, Context matters.” For many reasons, this war needs to be viewed through a different prism versus other wars of the 21st century.

WEEK AFTER WAR

Much analysis can be done to compare how stocks and other assets reacted to wars, but sometimes the most important indicator might lie in subtler movements. For example, the accompanying table compares how asset classes performed in the first week (five trading days) of war and how they evolved over the next year. We analysed this in the context of two major wars in the 21st century that involved crude oil spiking severely—the US-Iraq war of 2003 and the Russia-Ukraine war of 2022.

In the short term (one week), if your guess is: oil and dollar gain while equities plunge, you would be largely right. As you can see from the table, equities have, broadly, taken the hit. In 2022 though, US indices ended the week oddly in the green, as the market saw the US to be impacted less, relative to Europe (Europe was more dependent on Russian petroleum than the US was). As crude raced to \$115 a barrel from \$95, the US government announced release of strategic oil reserves, which could have comforted the market. This time around, all indices have closed the week in the red. Notably, Korean KOSPI saw the worst single-day decline (12.1 per cent) in its history—a record even the Asian financial crisis, dotcom bust, global financial crisis and the pandemic do not have.

Crude is up this time (29 per

Look beyond the narratives

MARKET WISE. Why the US-Iran war’s impact on markets needs to be viewed through a different prism versus past wars



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

cent) as it did after Russia struck Ukraine (17 per cent). However, it fell 5.5 per cent in the week after the US-Iraq war began. Oil had hit a peak of \$35 a barrel a few days before US invaded Iraq and had increased 52 per cent in four months till then. The market expected a quick success for the US in Iraq, explaining the 5.5 per cent drop in oil price. Oil then bottomed at about \$23 before setting off on ascent to its all-time high of \$148 by mid-July 2008.

While everyone may have noted all such big moves, today, probably the most important indicator lies in how the US’ 10-year bond yields have moved in the first week. In the previous two wars, the 10-year bond yields actually declined by 6 basis points (bps) and 11 bps in the first week after the war—a typical reaction when fear increases and investors take comfort in risk-free treasury bonds. However, this time, it has actually increased by 20 bps. With markets and bonds declining, investors fear uncertainty and inflation at the same time—there could be impact to the economy and jobs due to war, while at the same time, inflation too may increase and place the US Federal Reserve in a quandary.

WHY IT’S DIFFERENT NOW One can argue that even after the start of the Russia-Ukraine war, inflation was high and US Fed was raising policy rates. So why should we be more cautious this time? Here are a few reasons.

For one, when the US Fed increased interest rates in 2022, inflation was high, the impact of Covid stimulus was still providing

Battle moves

Asset classes	Change in %					
	1 week of war			1 year of war		
	US-Iraq	Russia-Ukraine	US-Iran	US-Iraq	Russia-Ukraine	US-Iran
Dow Jones Ind Avg	-0.4	2.3	-3.0	23.2	0.1	
S&P 500	-0.5	3.8	-2.0	27.0	-5.0	
Nasdaq Composite	-0.7	5.5	-1.2	38.9	-11.1	
DAX	-1.4	-4.3	-6.7	46.0	5.8	
FTSE 100	0.7	-0.9	-5.7	17.3	5.5	
Nikkei 225	3.7	-0.2	-5.5	41.8	2.5	
SSE Composite	-0.9	-0.1	-0.9	18.9	-5.8	
KOSPI	2.4	-0.6	-10.6	63.0	-10.3	
Nifty 50	1.0	-2.7	-2.9	71.8	2.6	
India VIX	NA	19.1	45.1	NA	-38.6	
CBOE VIX	-10.5	-0.9	48.5	-39.3	-31.9	
US 10-year govt bond yield*	-6	-11	20	-21	189	
Gold	-1.8	1.0	-2.0	22.6	-4.5	
Brent crude	-5.5	16.6	28.7	24.3	-15.1	
Dollar index	-1.0	1.2	1.4	-12.2	8.7	

Source: Bloomberg *basis points

support to consumption, jobs and the economy. This time, it is the opposite and if inflation were to increase due to higher oil prices now, it will be a double whammy. In fact, the US jobs data released last Friday revealed a weakening job market.

Two, in the past wars, oil-rich West Asian countries could profiteer by exporting crude at elevated prices. Petrodollars, in one way or the other, flowed back into the global economy either through their spending or sovereign wealth investments—driving some of the growth and market performance. This time, it’s different. Though prices are high, some of their refineries have been hit and it has become practically challenging to move crude out of the Persian Gulf due to the situ-

ation at the Strait of Hormuz. Thus, the high prices are not of much benefit to them or to the global economy. If the war persists, they may even be forced to consider selling some of their global investments across markets and asset classes, to meet their budgets.

Three, valuations, as always, make a difference, especially when things are as uncertain as now. If you look at the one-year performance after the previous two wars, the one-year market performance is amazing at best (after US-Iraq war) and not scary at worst (after Russia-Ukraine war). But here are a few things to note.

The period 2002-03 was when the global economy bottomed out after the bursting of the dotcom

bubble and slipped into a subsequent recession. Government debt to GDP was under control (US’ at 56 per cent by 2002 and 125 per cent by 2025), central banks’ policy rates were low. At the start of the 2003 war, the P/E multiples were low—S&P 500’s at 18x and the Nifty’s at 14x. In the year after the start of the Russia-Ukraine war, equities have given negative to marginally positive returns. When the war started, the P/E of S&P 500 and Nifty were 21x and 24x. This explains the weaker performance as compared to 2003-04.

Cut to today, the situation is complicated. Equities don’t exactly have a low base to build on. P/E multiples of S&P 500 and Nifty are at 26x and 23x respectively and are expensive. AI euphoria dominates US and Korean equities, while there is no clear idea how big AI disruption can get. Geopolitics is the hardest in decades. Tariff wars are also ongoing.

To summarise: As the US-Iraq war began, markets were coming off low valuations and laying the foundation for a new bull run. In contrast, the Russia-Ukraine war erupted during an ongoing bull market. The current US-Iran conflict, however, has emerged at a time when markets are already showing signs of fatigue and valuations are expensive.

So, howsoever optimistic an investor might be, these are times to wait and watch and follow the news before making investing decisions. As Steve Eisman of ‘Big Short’ fame says, ‘there is no need to be a hero’—applies well when it comes to markets in today’s context.

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

		Interest rate (%)		
Small Savings Scheme		Oct 1 - Dec 31, 2025	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Compounding frequency
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5 ^a	7.5 ^a	Annually
Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on Dec 31, 2025
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- My founder began his career in a clerical role at an MNC, but quickly rose to senior positions even before Independence.
- While I am a global leader in my products, I am still a small-cap stock. My largest shareholder is a listed company with a lower market capitalisation than mine.
- Recent business losses caused my stock to decline sharply, though I have delivered a CAGR of more than 25 per cent over the last decade.
- My stock has to climb 70 per cent from current levels to reach the price domestic institutions paid while subscribing to my recent offer.
- My 10-member board includes people with strong credentials from IITs, global universities, as well as the administrative service.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Last week’s stock: Shaily Engineering Plastics
Last week’s winner: Aman

Equity risk premium

EXPLAINED. Stocks and equity risk premiums are inversely correlated



GETTY IMAGES

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

As Kannan stares at his portfolio in disbelief over the losses in the last two weeks, he approaches Nitin for solace. The discussion veers into equity risk premium as Kannan realises that there is another side to returns apart from earnings growth.

Kannan: The fear is palpable in equity markets right now. Even without significant earnings downgrades, stocks are retracing on fear.

Nitin: Fear, sure, but the financial term for that is higher equity risk premium and yes investors are pricing more of it.

Kannan: Please elaborate.

Nitin: Think of owning one of two equal cash flows projections, one from a proven oil well and another from a prospective oil well. Naturally, you would pay less for cash flows from the prospective oil well. This is because you associate a higher risk from this one and you want to be compensated for the riskier asset by buying at a lower price.

Mathematically, the oil well cash flows for the next twenty years are discounted

to present day to arrive at a price.

But the riskier oil well will be discounted by a higher risk premium compared to the proven well. As the same cash flow is discounted to the present at a higher rate, it is lower than the other, which is the price difference.

Kannan: Are equities being subjected to the same principle now?

Nitin: Yes, the price you pay for a stock has two components. The earnings or cash flows that it will generate over the years.

This is then ‘discounted’ to the present day by a discount factor that is a combination of risk free rate and risk premium. The last two weeks were more a function of equity risk premium increasing.

There will be an earnings impact for sure, but for now, investors are more focussed on the equity risk premium side of the asset pricing equation.

Kannan: Risk premium for some sectors is understandable, but this has been a multi-sector free fall.

Nitin: Risk premium is for the asset class as an entity and not specific. And theoretically speaking, you are not

● MIND IT

All things remaining constant, stocks fall when equity risk premium goes up, and they move up when equity risk premium goes down

rewarded for specific risks in companies and sectors because you are expected to diversify away that specific risk.

Only the risk from investing in equity asset class, the risk which is over and above the safe government bonds, is what you are rewarded for. The risk premium is increasing due to uncertainty. This is the primary factor impacting equities now.

Of course, beyond what is explained, investors will have to deal with impact to earnings estimates, outlook on inflation, the rate path that central banks are likely to consider, and liquidity conditions; these are the big ticket items which are getting priced into equities. Once these factors are priced in and there is less uncertainty, the equity risk premium may start reducing

again. All things remaining constant, stocks fall when equity risk premium goes up, and they move up when equity risk premium goes down.

So you can say that stocks and equity risk premium are inversely correlated.

Kannan: Now I am beginning to see. Investor perception of risks reward with regard to equities as an asset class is the driver for markets.

Nitin: Yes. Consider expectation of high inflation; this will erode the cash flow you earn in the future, from any sector or company.

Or if global central banks start rising interest rates again, bonds become attractive compared to equities as a whole.

Or even general liquidity that will be affected which trickles down to investment vs saving. These are being priced in now.

Kannan: Got it. Not to forget, the month of April will witness earnings and most likely guidance announcements for next fiscal.

That is when earnings will start impacting equities. But then, watch out also for the equity risk premium to shrink once clarity emerges.

Venkatasubramanian K
bl. research bureau

After 18 months of market volatility, conditions were finally beginning to stabilise in February this year. This period also saw the presentation of a robust Budget and progress on the US trade deal, following agreements with the European Union and the UK.

However, with a war erupting again in West Asia last week, geopolitical concerns have returned to the fore, raising the risk of trade disruptions and oil price spikes.

All frontline and broader equity market indices had already come under pressure weeks before the war, amid fears over AI-led disruption to businesses and jobs, particularly in the software segment, and its likely spillover effect on domestic consumption.

In such times, a relatively safer approach for long-term investors would be to buy into large-cap funds, directing them towards specific goals.

Bandhan Large Cap fund can be a good addition for investors with a seven-year or higher perspective via the SIP route as a portfolio diversifier.

It has been an above-average performer in the category over the past 6-7 years. The scheme has a track record of nearly 20 years.

ABOVE-AVERAGE SHOW

Though Bandhan Large Cap was a moderate performer in the period just before Covid-19, its performance has been strong thereafter.

Over one, three, five and seven-year timeframes, the fund has outperformed the Nifty 100 TRI by 1.5-3.4 percentage points.

The fund's five-year point-to-point returns are healthy at 14.2 per cent, which compare favourably with peers in the category.

When five-year rolling returns are considered from January 2018 to February 2026, the fund has outperformed the Nifty 100 TRI over 76 per cent of the time. The mean return for the fund is 16.8 per cent, while for the Nifty 100 TRI, it is 16.1 per cent.

Over this rolling period and timeframe, Bandhan Large Cap has delivered more than 12 per cent for over 82 per cent of the

Long-term vision

FUND CALL. Bandhan Large Cap Fund can be a good addition for a seven-year or longer horizon as a portfolio diversifier in volatile markets

time and in excess of 15 per cent for over 68 per cent of the time.

When returns on monthly SIPs (XIRR) over the past 10 years are considered, the fund has delivered 14.7 per cent. A similar SIP in the Nifty 100 TRI would have returned 13.6 per cent.

The fund has an upside capture ratio of nearly 107.7, indicating that its NAV rises a bit more than the benchmark during rallies. It has a downside capture ratio of 100.6, indicating that the scheme's NAV falls almost in line with the benchmark during corrections. A score of 100 indicates that a fund performs exactly in line with its benchmark. This inference is based on data for the period between March 2021 to March 2026.

All return figures and the ratios pertain to the direct plan of the fund.

STEADY PORTFOLIO MIX

In keeping with its mandate, Bandhan Large Cap fund predominantly holds only large-cap stocks, usually clocking 80-85 per cent of the portfolio. When broader markets are attractive

WHY INVEST

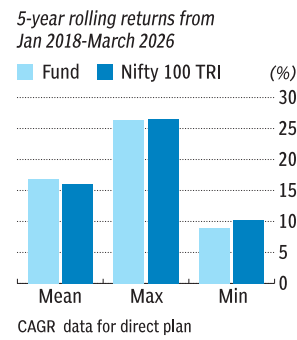
- Consistent outperformance against Nifty 100 TRI across timeframes
- Predominantly large-cap portfolio with selective mid- and small-cap exposure
- Healthy long-term SIP returns versus the benchmark

and vibrant, the fund takes 12-15 per cent exposure in mid- and small-caps.

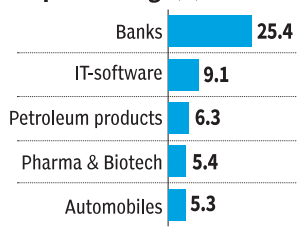
Bandhan Large Cap Fund holds a little over 60 stocks, making the portfolio diversified without being overly diffused. Except for the top four or five holdings, no individual stock accounts for more than 4 per cent of the portfolio.

In terms of sector holdings, banks have always figured on top of the pile and have accounted for over a quarter of the overall portfolio. Given the segment's relative outperformance since the market peak of

Steady above-average performance



Top 5 holdings (%)



Source: ACE MF; Jan 2026

September 2024, the fund's own returns have been helped by higher exposure to the sector as well as to the financial services space.

Interestingly, the IT and soft-

ware segment has been among the top holdings of the fund across timelines.

However, the fund has been decreasing exposure to the sector over the past one year and it is now in single digits as AI-led disruption knocked out considerable value from frontline stocks.

Petroleum products (refiners) have also been a prominent part of the fund's portfolio.

Higher exposure to pharmaceutical, biotechnology and automobile companies has also contributed to Bandhan Large Cap Fund's strong performance over the past couple of years.

The FMCG segment does not have much prominence in the fund, nor does retailing. These segments have been heavy underperformers in recent years as business (alternative channels) and demand disruptions have hurt their prospects.

The fund's picks in most sectors are restricted to the top two or three stocks.

Overall, Bandhan Large Cap is a steady rather than spectacular performer that can deliver above-average returns over 7-10-year timeframes.

frequency drops further to about 3 per cent for large-caps, 6 per cent for mid-caps and 18 per cent for small-caps. This pattern highlights the importance of staying invested for longer periods. Interestingly, the AMFI Annual Report 2025 shows that despite improving investor behaviour, a large share of SIP assets are still held for shorter periods. As of March 2025, about 81 per cent of direct SIP assets and 67 per cent of regular SIP assets were held for less than five years.

MARKET-CAP CURVE

Return volatility rises significantly as one moves down the market-cap ladder. The worst 3-year SIP return on the Nifty 100 was -22.7 per cent, while the best was 29.5 per cent, a spread of about 52 percentage points. For the Nifty Midcap 150, the range widens from -33.6 per cent to 40.8 per cent, a spread of about 74 percentage points. On the Nifty Smallcap 250, the range stretches from -37.8 per cent to 46 per cent, nearly 84 percentage points. The same pattern holds for 5-year SIP returns. The Nifty 100 has delivered between -3.1 per cent and 23.1 per cent across 5-year periods. The Nifty Midcap 150 has ranged between -6.9 per cent and 36.4 per cent, while the Nifty Smallcap 250 has swung between -17 per cent and 38.5 per cent.

TAKEAWAY

The key takeaway is straightforward. Those investing in mid- and small-cap funds through SIPs need patience. A horizon of at least seven years, and ideally 10 years, is necessary to smooth out volatility. The shorter the investment horizon, the higher the chances of seeing negative or below fixed-deposit returns. Large-cap funds are relatively more stable, but even there a three-year horizon may be too short. Staying invested and allowing time to work remains the most reliable way to benefit from SIP investing.

With inputs from Kumar Shankar Roy

ALERTS.

Kotak MF's Quality Overseas Equity Omni FOF

Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund (MF) has launched Kotak Quality Overseas Equity Omni FOF, an open-ended fund of fund investing in units of overseas equity oriented mutual fund schemes based on quality theme and/or ETFs based on quality theme. The NFO closes on March 20, 2026. The entry load is nil. The exit load will be 1 per cent for redemptions/switch outs within 90 days from the date of allotment and nil for

redemptions/switch outs after 90 days. The minimum subscription amount is ₹1,000 and any amount thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked against MSCI World Index (TRI); its fund managers are Arjun Khanna and Abhishek Bisen.

The Wealth Company Small Cap Fund

The Wealth Company Mutual Fund has launched The Wealth Company Small Cap Fund, an open-ended equity scheme predominantly investing in small-cap stocks. The NFO closes on March 18, 2026. The entry load is nil for the scheme. The exit load will be 1 per cent if units are redeemed/switched-out within a year from the date of allotment and nil if units are redeemed/switched-out after a year from the date of allotment.

The minimum subscription amount is ₹10,000 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked to NIFTY SmallCap 250 index (TRI); its fund manager is Aparna Shanker.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
as on March 6				
ETF				
Groww Nifty Defence	85.3	85.4	5.3	3,668
Mirae NYSE FANG+ ETF	134.0	161.8	4.0	2,141
Mirae BSE Defence ETF	69.8	69.9	3.5	995
Groww Nifty PSE ETF	103.5	103.9	0.8	41
Mirae Nifty 8-13Y Gsec ETF	29.9	30.0	0.8	9
Mirae S&P500 Top50 ETF	58.1	71.0	0.8	1,361
CPSE ETF	103.9	103.7	0.8	14,805
GOLD ETFs				
Angel One Gold ETF	157.8	14.8	-0.1	7,591
Baroda BNPP Gold ETF	152.5	153.1	-0.2	175
Tata Gold ETF	15.3	15.3	-0.4	792,625

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on March 6, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Mar 6	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	7-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
Kotak Pension Fund	68.1	15.6	13.7	14.77	4,453
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	73.4	15.9	13.7	14.46	26,748
HDFC Pension Fund	54.2	15.0	13.0	14.36	73,376
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.9	7.8	6.6	8.12	8,283
ABSL Pension Scheme	19.2	7.9	6.6	7.99	2,647
SBI Pension Fund	41.3	7.9	6.5	7.85	26,993
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.2	8.6	7.4	8.62	31,632
ABSL Pension Scheme	20.1	8.3	7.1	8.31	1,574
SBI Pension Fund	45.6	8.4	7.0	8.25	14,319
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
Kotak Pension Fund	59.8	15.5	13.7	14.6	219
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	58.0	15.8	13.7	14.5	755
HDFC Pension Fund	46.8	15.0	13.0	14.3	1,805

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on March 6, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	312	11.5	20.4	26.6
ICICI Pru	Largecap	904	13.7	21.4	20.9
Renaissance Investment	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	3.6	17.0	18.3
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	10.6	20.9	17.9
MULTI CAP					
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	-4.0	20.7	27.9
Invasnet	Growth Pro Max	344	-0.4	32.6	27.6
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	134	7.6	30.6	27.2
Negen Capital Services	Special Situ & Tech Fund	1,222	3.3	25.0	26.8
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	8,402	18.2	23.8	26.7
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	6,361	7.2	38.5	26.6
MID-CAP					
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-0.8	18.1	20.8
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	-5.1	16.4	20.8
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	340	4.3	16.7	20.6
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	3.8	19.2	20.3
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	4,862	62.3	52.5	49.2
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	779	-11.3	22.1	39.6
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,123	-13.5	31.6	30.8
Accuracap	Dynamo	13	0.3	28.6	25.0

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on January 31, 2026

When SIP returns get uncomfortable

INVEST-WISE. We unpack the risks of short tenures, sub-optimal returns and volatility

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Indian equity markets have been in a corrective phase since September 2024, and the impact on SIP returns in equity mutual funds has been swift and visible. As highlighted in our earlier report (https://tinyurl.com/4jnrtrjmh), the 3-year SIP return in actively managed IT funds recently slipped into negative territory, the first such instance since the pandemic-led market disruption of early 2020.

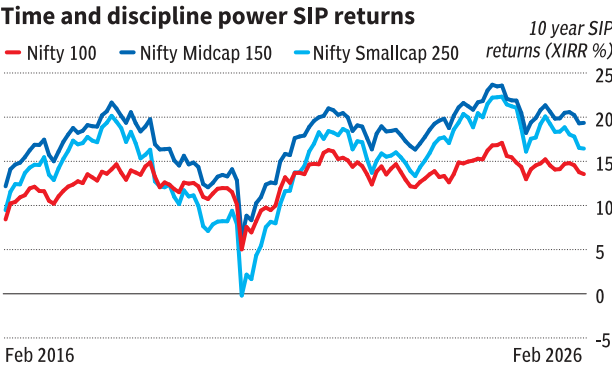
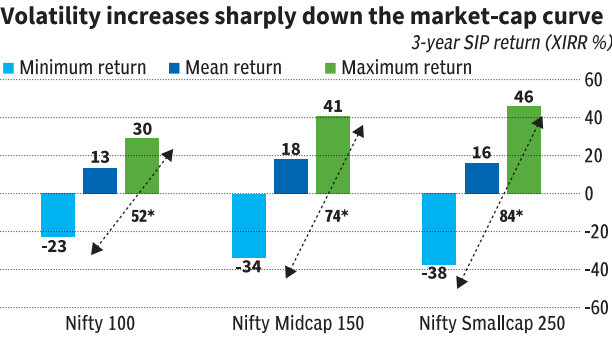
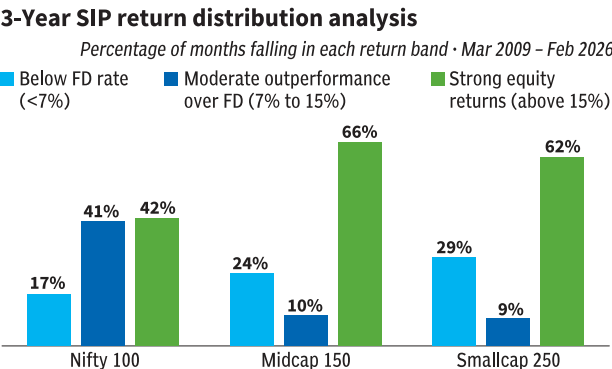
Against this backdrop of volatility, how has the broader market SIP performed? A bl.portfolio analysis of 3-year rolling SIP returns on the Nifty 100 Total Return Index (TRI), a proxy for large-cap stocks, shows the XIRR falling from about 25 per cent in September 2024 to 9.7 per cent by February 2026. The decline is sharper in the broader market. The 3-year SIP return for the Nifty Midcap 150 TRI has dropped from 39 per cent to 14 per cent over the same period, while the Nifty Smallcap 250 has fallen from 40 per cent to 7.2 per cent.

For investors tracking their SIP dashboards, the decline is difficult to ignore. But does it point to a deeper problem, or is it simply part of the normal ups and downs of the market? To answer this, we examine rolling SIP returns across 3-, 5-, 7-, 10- and 15-year periods to understand what longer-dated data actually show. For this study, 20 years of data from the Total Return Indices of the Nifty 100, Nifty Midcap 150 and Nifty Smallcap 250 were analysed. SIP returns were computed assuming monthly installments using month-end index values. SIP returns are measured using XIRR, or extended internal rate of return, which calculates the annualised return for investments made at different dates and amounts, as is the case with periodic SIP installments.

NEGATIVE RETURNS

The data show that negative SIP outcomes do occur, but their

Short holding periods raise SIP risk



*percentage points **7 per cent is assumed here as the fixed deposit benchmark For this study, 20 years of data from the Total Return Indices of the Nifty 100, Nifty Midcap 150 and Nifty Smallcap 250 were analysed. SIP returns were computed assuming monthly installments using month-end index values. bl.portfolio compilation

frequency depends heavily on the segment and the holding period. They are a normal part of equity investing, especially over shorter holding periods. Three-year SIP returns have turned negative during market stress periods such as the global financial crisis of 2008-09 and the pandemic shock of 2020.

Even in the relatively stable Nifty 100, a 3-year SIP has delivered negative returns in 9 out of 204 months, or about 4 per

cent of the time. In the Nifty Midcap 150, negative outcomes occurred in 20 months, or roughly 10 per cent of the time. The frequency is much higher in the Nifty Smallcap 250, where a 3-year SIP generated negative returns in 45 months, accounting for about 22 per cent of the observations.

The depth of losses also varies sharply across segments. The worst 3-year SIP return on the Nifty Smallcap 250 was -37.8 per

cent, compared with -33.6 per cent on the Nifty Midcap 150 and -22.7 per cent on the Nifty 100. Another striking aspect is the duration of such phases. The Nifty Smallcap 250 remained in negative 3-year SIP return territory for 26 consecutive months during the period between September 2018 and October 2020. In contrast, the longest such stretch was just four months for the Nifty 100 and five months for the Nifty Midcap 150.

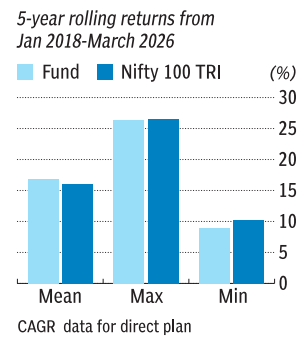
The encouraging takeaway is that the risk of negative outcomes falls sharply as the investment horizon increases. At a 7-year tenure, only the Nifty Smallcap 250 has briefly slipped into negative territory, with a return of about -6 per cent. At 10 years, even smallcap has touched near-zero only once, at -0.2 per cent. Large- and mid-cap indices have not produced negative SIP returns beyond five-year periods.

3-YEAR LARGE-CAP SIP

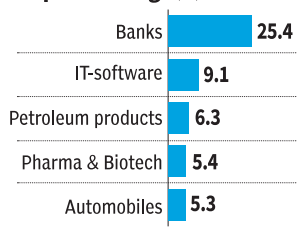
The 3-year rolling SIP data for the Nifty 100 shows that the return fell below 7 per cent, assumed here as the fixed deposit benchmark, in 34 out of 204 months. That is about 17 per cent of the time. The proportion rises to around 24 per cent for mid-caps and nearly 29 per cent for small-caps. The incidence of such underperformance declines as the holding period increases. For a 5-year SIP, the share of periods with returns below 7 per cent falls to about 10 per cent for large-caps and around 14 per cent for mid-caps. However, for small-caps it remains relatively high at about 30 per cent, reflecting the deeper drawdowns typical of this segment.

With a 7-year SIP tenure, the

Steady above-average performance



Top 5 holdings (%)



Source: ACE MF; Jan 2026

September 2024, the fund's own returns have been helped by higher exposure to the sector as well as to the financial services space.

Interestingly, the IT and soft-

VERSUS BANK FD

Three-year rolling SIP returns fell below the FD benchmark 17% of the time for large-caps, 24% for mid-caps, and 29% for small-caps

cent, compared with -33.6 per cent on the Nifty Midcap 150 and -22.7 per cent on the Nifty 100. Another striking aspect is the duration of such phases. The Nifty Smallcap 250 remained in negative 3-year SIP return territory for 26 consecutive months during the period between September 2018 and October 2020. In contrast, the longest such stretch was just four months for the Nifty 100 and five months for the Nifty Midcap 150.

The encouraging takeaway is that the risk of negative outcomes falls sharply as the investment horizon increases. At a 7-year tenure, only the Nifty Smallcap 250 has briefly slipped into negative territory, with a return of about -6 per cent. At 10 years, even smallcap has touched near-zero only once, at -0.2 per cent. Large- and mid-cap indices have not produced negative SIP returns beyond five-year periods.

3-YEAR LARGE-CAP SIP

The 3-year rolling SIP data for the Nifty 100 shows that the return fell below 7 per cent, assumed here as the fixed deposit benchmark, in 34 out of 204 months. That is about 17 per cent of the time. The proportion rises to around 24 per cent for mid-caps and nearly 29 per cent for small-caps. The incidence of such underperformance declines as the holding period increases. For a 5-year SIP, the share of periods with returns below 7 per cent falls to about 10 per cent for large-caps and around 14 per cent for mid-caps. However, for small-caps it remains relatively high at about 30 per cent, reflecting the deeper drawdowns typical of this segment.

With a 7-year SIP tenure, the

Beer gains, but foam too

ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES. United Breweries’ premium push & margin gains help, but expensive valuations limit fresh upside

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

In our August 2025 note, we had advised investors of beer giant United Breweries (UBL) to ‘book profits’ when the stock was around ₹1,924, flagging stretched valuations and optimistic earnings expectations. Since then, the stock first extended the rally to a 52-week high of ₹2,291, before a sharp 39 per cent correction dragged it to a 52-week low of ₹1,401. In the past few sessions, the stock has bounced back to about ₹1,758. This is after reports said the Karnataka government announced a shift to a global taxation standard and the complete deregulation of alcohol pricing. The recent bounce also reflects optimism after UBL’s Q3FY26 margins surprised on the upside even as volumes stayed soft, with many betting on a ‘better weather, better demand’ thesis for FY27.

After this round trip, the risk-reward is a tad better than it was at the time of our ‘book-profit’ call. That said, UBL at 61x EV/EBITDA (based on the last 12-month period) still carries a hefty valuation premium versus global brewers and even Indian alco-beverage peers (42x United Spirits and 45x Radico Khaitan). This is despite a relatively-modest margin profile and uneven growth history for UBL. The broader backdrop doesn’t help. With crude back in focus amid West Asia tensions, and market already grappling with expensive valuations and rising worries around AI-led disruption, risk appetite can swing sharply.

For UBL, a durable rerating will likely need sustained earnings and margin upgrades over multiple quarters, not just one strong quarter or State-specific triggers. We therefore move to a ‘hold’ stance. Existing investors can stay invested, but avoid chasing the rebound or adding meaningfully unless valuations turn more comfortable or margin and growth gains prove durable.

BUSINESS

UBL, part of the global Heineken group, is one of India’s largest beer makers, with the ‘Kingfisher’ among the most recognisable brands in the category. It operates a pan-India manufacturing network with 24



● HOLD

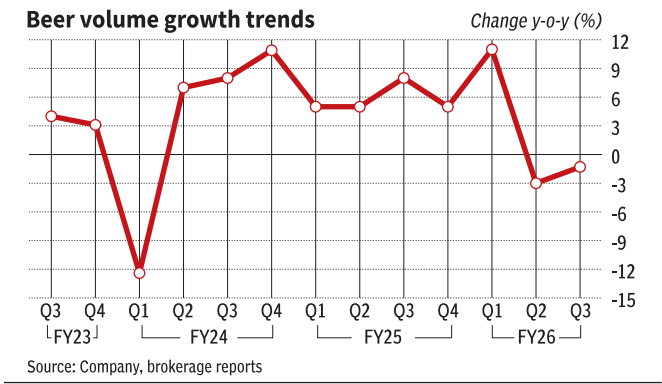
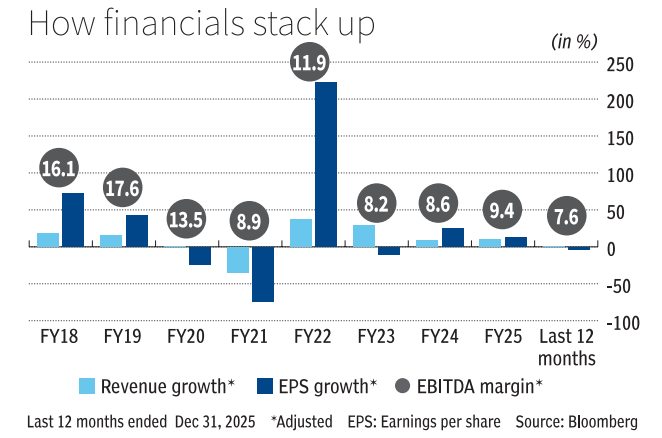
United Breweries
₹1757.65

WHY

- Valuations remain rich despite sharp correction from peak
- Margin gains need consistency; volumes are still uneven
- Long-term beer growth story and market leadership remain

million hectolitres of capacity, comprising 19 owned breweries and 17 contract breweries, and commands an estimated 48-49 per cent market share. UBL’s business model hinges on two levers. One, driving category growth in a market that remains underpenetrated and heavily regulated at the State level. Two, improving profitability in a structurally-tough sector through mix, pricing actions and tighter execution. Over the past year, the management has sharpened focus on premiumisation, while also pushing innovations in mainstream segment to widen appeal.

A key operational focus has been localising premium supplies and optimising the brewery footprint to cut costs and improve agility across key States. UBL has also invested in demand creation and availability, expanding its visi-cooler footprint, as beer is largely a sold-cold category, and strengthening glass, barley and can supplies ahead of the peak season. At the same time, the operating environment remains volatile. Weather can distort quarterly volumes, while State taxes, duty structures and policy



shifts limit pricing power. UBL’s near-term performance will therefore depend on how well execution-led margin gains offset these external pressures.

FINANCIALS

UBL’s recent numbers show a familiar divergence: margins are improving, but volumes remain patchy (see table). In Q3FY26 (quarter ended December 31, 2025), revenue from operations (gross of excise duty) stood at ₹3,937 crore, down from ₹4,427 crore in Q3FY25, reflecting weather-led disruption and affordability pressures in key markets. Yet profitability improved sharply; profit before exceptional items and tax rose to ₹151

crore (₹87 crore). After exceptional items, profit after tax was ₹81 crore (₹39 crore). However, the picture over 9MFY26 is more subdued. Revenue for the nine months was ₹13,055 crore (₹14,981 crore), and profit for the period was about ₹312 crore (₹345 crore). This indicates that although PAT grew in Q3, the number for nine months has declined y-o-y. The beer volume trend underlines this further. After 11 per cent year-on-year growth in Q1FY26, UBL saw -3 per cent in Q2FY26 and -1.3 per cent in Q3FY26. The management attributes the Q3 decline to unseasonal rains in October and weak demand in some States, with Telangana, Ra-

jasthan and Karnataka dragging, partly offset by Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra. Even so, it flags “green shoots” in January, with industry volumes up 4-5 per cent and premium segment growth holding up.

Management said Q3 delivered its highest gross margin in three years, helped by favourable price-mix, operating leverage and early gains from productivity initiatives. Realisations rose 5 per cent, split roughly equally between price and mix. It is also targeting 300-600 basis points of cost savings over FY26-28, even as aluminium and barley inflation remain risks. About half of this savings the company intends to reinvest. The key monitor now is whether margin gains sustain even if volume recovery stays uneven. For perspective, Bloomberg data show UBL’s last 12-month adjusted EBITDA margin at about 7.6 per cent, versus 15-18 per cent for Radico Khaitan and United Spirits, and 33-40 per cent for global beer majors such as Ambev, Constellation Brands and Anheuser-Busch.

VALUATION & RISKS

Bloomberg consensus estimates pencil in 6.3 per cent and 45.2 per cent adjusted EPS growth for FY26 and FY27 respectively, after 9.8 per cent growth in FY25. For revenue (adjusted), the growth rates are 6.7 per cent in FY26 and that almost doubles to 12.7 per cent for FY27. Such optimistic projections for FY27 make one-year forward valuation (39x EV/EVITDA) optically cheaper & should be taken with caution. UBL, a pure play on India’s beer story, is investing in breweries, supply chain and infrastructure to support volume growth. But at current valuations, meaningful near-term gains look unlikely. The long-term case remains intact, with beer still just 10 per cent of total alcohol consumption in India and per capita intake below many markets. Even so, investors should stay measured: without a sharp rise in beer consumption or lower input costs, the expected margin rise may not materialise. UBL remains expensive versus peers on absolute & relative valuations. While recent market share gains and structural investments support the long-term case, the stock appears to price in most positives.

Taking Stock • bl • 5

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

REALITY CHECK.

AMCs defy markets, enjoy outperformance and premium valuations

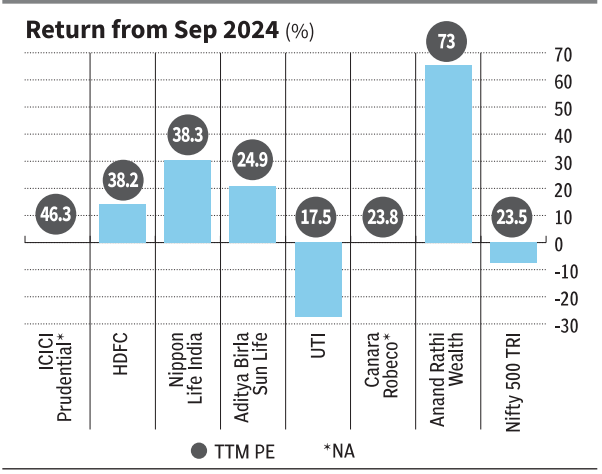
Venkatasubramanian K
bl. research bureau

In a largely downward moving and volatile equity environment that has prevailed over the past 18 months, investors would expect a segment that is closely linked to the fortunes of the markets to underperform.

Listed players in the ₹81-lakh crore mutual fund industry have defied wars, geopolitical tensions, penal trade tariffs, AI-led disruptions etc. that have shaken markets over the past 1.5 years, and have thrived.

Most domestic asset management companies (AMCs) have not only delivered robust returns over this period, but are also trading at a valuation premium to the broader markets.

AMCs and wealth management companies delivered 14-65 per cent returns from September 2024 to March 2026, while the Nifty 500 TRI fell 7.5 per cent in this timeframe.



And barring one player, other AMC stocks trade at trailing twelve months’ PE (price earnings) multiple of 23.8 times to 46.3 times, while the Nifty 500 TRI trades at a PE of 23.5 times. The lone wealth management firm taken here commands a TTM PE of 73 times.

Interestingly, within the AMC space, the top mutual fund houses command a substantial valuation premium over the others in the listed space.

EXPLAINING THE OUTPERFORMANCE

Despite the fall in the markets and the general negativity around equities, the mutual fund industry has been able to pull in assets at a robust clip.

HDFC, Nippon Life India and ICICI Prudential saw their average quarterly assets under management as of December 2025 grow 17.5-23.2 per cent year on year.

The likes of UTI, Canara Robeco and Aditya Birla Sun Life saw assets swell 11.7-15.5 per cent over the same period.

This growth in assets has also been accompanied by expanding profits. All AMCs witnessed growth in profits. The leading ones saw up to 29 per cent growth in TTM net profit growth.

Anand Rath Wealth, too, managed a TTM net profit growth of 29 per cent.

UTI and Nippon Life India alone experienced single-digit growth in profits.

Fund house	TTM profit growth (%)	AUM growth y-o-y (%)	MCap to AUM (%)	AUM (Dec 2025; ₹ cr)
ICICI Prudential	29	23.2	13.7	10,76,380
HDFC	21.8	17.5	11.6	9,24,854
Nippon Life India	8	23.0	7.8	7,00,958
Aditya Birla Sun Life	12	15.5	6.0	4,43,233
UTI	5	11.7	3.2	3,93,809
Canara Robeco	26	12.8	3.7	1,22,254
Anand Rath Wealth	29			

Source: AMFI, NSE, bl.portfolio calculation; TTM Profit and AUM growth are from Dec 2024-Dec 2025; TTM PE is based on current price (Mar 6) TTM: Trailing 12 months; Yield: TTM Operating revenue to AUM; Mcap: Market capitalisation; Index PE figures are as of Feb 2026. Anand Rath Wealth has been included as it is mainly focused on mutual fund products (distribution and advisory) catering to HNIs

The sustainability of these valuations will depend on inflows into fund houses remaining steady, especially via the SIP route and AMCs continuing nimble operations to deliver above-average profit growth. A serious job-loss scenario in the broader economy due to AI-led disruptions, a prolonged war that induces inflation and sustained weakness in the markets may test this healthy run.

DIVERGENCE IN VALUATIONS

It is also noticeable that on the PE metric and the market capitalisation to AUM parameter, there is considerable difference between the top three listed players and the next three.

One key reason for this premium lies in the market share the larger AMCs pull in.

ICICI Prudential, HDFC and Nippon Life India make up over 33 per cent of the total asset management in the industry and they accounted nearly 38 per cent of the inflows over December 2024-December 2025 period.

In contrast, the other three players accounted for 11 per cent of the industry’s assets and just about 9 per cent of the inflows in the last one year.

ICICI Prudential (with leadership in large-cap, value and opportunities) and HDFC (flexi-cap, mid-and small-cap) have most of their equity and hybrid schemes in the top quartile of those categories.

Nippon Life India has leadership in mid- and small-caps, passive funds with its gold and silver ETFs enjoying the highest AUM in the industry.

Aditya Birla Sun Life and UTI have a patchy equity fund record in recent years, which explains their lower inflows. Canara Robeco does have a few funds in the top or mid quartiles, though some have faced the brunt of the recent sharp correction in the broader markets.

Hot summer, hotter sales

EMS. Demand for air-conditioners and diversification into new categories crucial for PG Electroplast stock

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

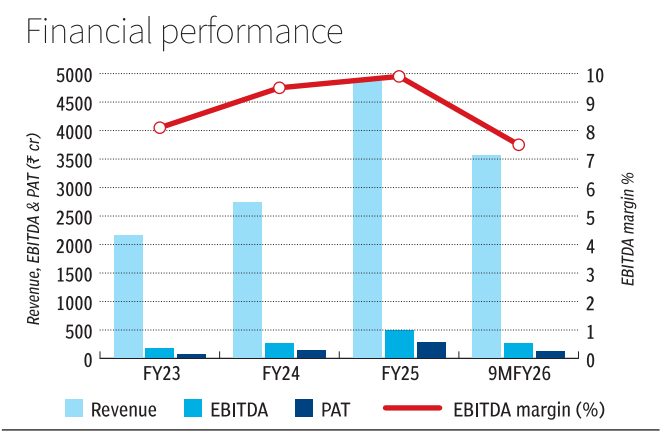
PG Electroplast (PGEL) is an electronic manufacturing services company with a strong focus on room air conditioners (RAC). Along with rising RAC penetration in India, it has reported a 39 per cent CAGR growth in revenues during FY16-25 and now accounts for 11-12 per cent of overall RACs manufactured in India.

The RAC market faced weak demand last year owing to early onset of monsoons and the stock of PGEL corrected 30 per cent in the last one year. Resumption of RAC demand on a weak base is crucial for the stock, even as consumer durable growth in the long term is expected. The stock is trading at 43 times one-year forward earnings, which is at a 7 per cent premium to its last five-year average. We recommend investors hold the stock at current valuations when long-term potential must be weighed against resumption of RAC growth momentum in the upcoming Summer season.

The company reported revenues of ₹1,412 crore in Q3FY26, which is a 45 per cent year-on-year growth. Around ₹1,140 crore or 80 per cent of the revenues are from products and the rest from plastic moulding and electronics. RACs contributed ₹932 crore in the quarter, an 80 per cent growth. Washing machines contributed ₹194 crore, up 45 per cent.

RAC SECTOR OUTLOOK

As mentioned, RAC sales are coming off a weak base last year. The industry reported strong growth till April 2025 but sales dried up in May 2025 with early onset of the monsoon. The channel inventory was high and



● HOLD

PG Electroplast ₹608

WHY

- AC demand in summer a crucial support
- Portfolio diversification ongoing
- Valuation now factors drivers and risks fairly well after correction

primary sales (manufacturer to channel) declined significantly. For PGEL, revenue growth in Q1/Q2FY26 of 14 per cent/-2 per cent is in stark contrast to 77 per cent growth in FY25.

Sales growth resumed in Q3FY26 with 46 per cent growth, but this can be ascribed to implementation of new star ratings. New Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) star ratings are effective January 1, 2026, which are stricter norms that rate goods as 5-star to 1-star, based on their energy efficiency. The

older inventory had to be pushed into the channel before the deadline, a move which supported the revenue growth in Q3FY26.

Heading into Q4FY26, the strongest season for RAC, with channel inventory at higher levels (first from weak season and later from older-rated RACs), the demand will be a key monitoring factor.

Over a longer term, rising middle-class’ affordability, soaring temperatures and local PLI-supported manufacturing

should aid RAC penetration in the country, which stood at 8 per cent as of September 2025, according to ICRA. While GST cuts do not impact RAC purchase decisions, the lower GST rates and lower interest rates should support higher demand in the longer term.

DIVERSIFICATION

Washing machine sales accounted for 14 per cent of sales in Q3FY26. PGEL aims to grow the segment from a smaller base by adding new clients and increasing their wallet share. The company has a strong presence in the

Bear game

F&O TRACKER.

Nifty futures can slip to 24,000 and Nifty Bank futures may drop to 57,000

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,450) and Bank Nifty (57,783) fell 2.9 per cent and 4.5 per cent respectively last week. The chart of index futures and the derivatives positioning show a bearish bias. Here is our analysis:

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (March) (24,546) opened with a gap-down last Monday. It extended the decline and made a low of 24,427 on Wednesday. While it attempted to rally, it could not reclaim the 25,000-mark.

The price action shows a clear bearish bias in Nifty futures. However, there is a potential support at 24,430. Given the current bearish momentum, the contract is likely to breach this level. In such a case, it can drop to 24,000.

On the other hand, if Nifty futures rallies from the current level of 24,546, it will face a resistance at 25,000.

Even if the contract breaks out of this hurdle, it ought to surpass 25,500 to turn the outlook positive. Until then, the sellers might

use higher levels to create fresh shorts, weighing on the contract. In line with the chart's bearish inclination, the futures has seen fresh short build-up.

That is, as the March contract slipped 3.1 per cent last week, its outstanding open interest increased 10 per cent to 157 lakh contracts.

That said, the Put Call Ratio of March monthly options stood at 1.14 on Friday, showing a positive bias. A ratio greater than 1 is because of selling of relatively greater number of puts when compared to calls.

Overall, at the current juncture, the probability of a decline is high. But since there is a support ahead, traders might have to wait before going short afresh.

Strategy: Sell Nifty futures (March) if it slips below the support at 24,430. Target and stop-loss can be 24,000 and 24,630.

In case the March contract moves up to 24,800, go short. Target and stop-loss can be 24,000 and 25,100 respectively.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (March) (58,079) began last Monday's session with a considerable gap-down and witnessed an intraday decline.

The bears dragged the contract further, particularly on Fri-

BROAD TREND

- Short build-up on index futures
- But there could be a minor rally
- Traders can go short on a rise

day, when it lost 2.2 per cent in one session. For the week, it lost 4.6 per cent.

The price action shows the bears are holding the advantage and further decline is likely to occur. But before the next downswing, there could be a corrective rally, possibly to the 58,600-58,850 price band.

So, after reaching these levels, the contract can resume the downtrend.

Once the fall resumes, Nifty Bank futures (March) can drop to 57,000.

However, if it can break out of the barrier at 59,000, the outlook can turn positive. This can po-

tentially lead to a rally to 60,500.

Supporting the bearish inclination, there has been a notable short build-up on Nifty Bank futures (March). Along with a 4.6 per cent decline last week, the outstanding open interest shot up by 46 per cent to 21.5 lakh contracts.

In addition, the PCR of March options on Nifty Bank stood at nearly 0.80 on Friday, a bearish sign.

Overall, the price action and the futures and options data hint at the likelihood of further fall. Hence, traders can consider going short.

Strategy: Wait for Nifty Bank futures to rise to 58,600 and then go short. Target and stop-loss can be 57,000 and 59,200 respectively.

Instead, if the March futures slips below 58,000, sell with a stop-loss at 58,300 for a target of 57,000.

Short futures vs synthetic short

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Reward-risk trade-off should fix choice between futures & options

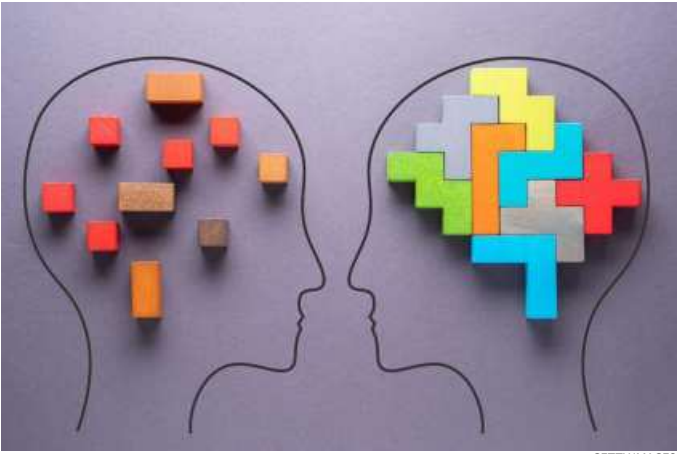
Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Suppose you have a negative outlook on an underlying. And you want to choose between shorting futures and setting up a synthetic short position using options. Which should you prefer? This week, we compare these two strategies and show why shorting futures is more optimal.

SHORT VS SYNTHETIC

Technically, the choice between futures and options should be based on reward-risk trade-off. If you are confident that the underlying is likely to decline, you may want to short futures, as futures price moves nearly one-to-one with the underlying. Your confidence on the price movement comes from reading the chart. If the pattern is strong, your confidence level would be higher. So, by logical extension, if your confidence on the price movement is not high, you may want to use options. The argument is that going long on an option limits your maximum loss to the premium paid. That said, experienced traders may still prefer shorting futures with a strict stop-loss.

So, what is synthetic short? It involves going long on an at-the-



QUICK TIP

By setting up the synthetic short, traders are anticipating the decline in the underlying will lead to intrinsic value gains from the put

money (ATM) put and short on an ATM call of the same expiry on an underlying. The position is called synthetic short because it behaves like a short underlying. If the underlying declines, the put will generate gains, as it will

become in-the-money (ITM). If the underlying moves up instead, the short call will generate losses, as it will become ITM. The synthetic short will give the same payoff as a short underlying if two conditions are met. One, the premium paid on the long put can be exactly offset by the premium received on the short call. And two, the strike is equal to the underlying price. But these two conditions are unlikely to be met most of the time. Often, the cost of the put may be higher than the premium received on the call because the chosen strike may be marginally higher than

the underlying. So, the synthetic short position may offer lower gains. Also, the effect of net time decay can dampen gains. So, why set up a synthetic short position?

Traders may prefer synthetic short position just after the underlying has paused after a sharp uptrend. At that time, calls would be in high demand compared to puts. So, call implied volatility is likely to be higher than that of put implied volatility. By setting up the synthetic short, traders are anticipating that the decline in the underlying will lead to intrinsic value gains from the put. Also, the time decay gains from the call will be accelerated if implied volatility declines.

OPTIONAL READING

Synthetic short position exposes you to similar risk as short futures. Also, the cash outflow on the synthetic short position is higher because it includes margins on the short call and the premium paid on the long put. It is, therefore, optimal to initiate short futures than synthetic short position for a given negative outlook on the underlying.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Gains ahead

BULLION CUES. Consider fresh buys

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$5,171/ounce) and silver (\$84.50/ounce) slipped 2.1 per cent and 10 per cent respectively over the last week.

In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,61,634/10gm) lost 0.3 per cent whereas silver futures (₹2,68,285/kg) was down 5.1 per cent. Here is our analysis.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,61,634)
Gold futures (April) began last week with a gap-up and marked a high of ₹1,69,880 on Monday. But there was no follow-through rally.

Nevertheless, the gold futures remain above the key support at ₹1,58,500. We expect the contract to build a fresh leg of rally towards ₹1,80,000.

But if the contract falls, it can find support at ₹1,58,500 and ₹1,54,000.

Trade strategy: Buy gold futures (April) now at ₹1,61,634. Place stop-loss at ₹1,54,000. When the contract rises to ₹1,72,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,67,000. Exit at ₹1,80,000.



MCX-SILVER (₹2,68,285)
Silver futures (May) rallied last Monday to hit a high of ₹2,97,799. It reversed direction on the same day and dropped. But since Tuesday, the contract has been trading between ₹2,60,000 and ₹2,76,000.

While the contract stays above the 21-day moving average support, there are resistances at ₹2,76,000 and ₹2,79,000. Only if the latter is breached, silver futures can see a rise to ₹3,20,000.

The contract can find support at ₹2,60,000 and ₹2,50,000.

Trade strategy: Buy silver futures (May) if it breaks out of ₹2,79,000. Stop-loss can be ₹2,58,000. When the contract touches ₹3,00,000, raise the stop-loss to ₹2,75,000. Book profits at ₹3,20,000.

Bulls in charge

CRUDE CHECK. Buy crude oil futures on a dip

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices skyrocketed last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$92.70/barrel) surged 27.2 per cent. The price of this contract has stayed above \$90 for the first time since April 2024. Notably, it hit an intra-week high of \$94.64 on Friday.

Crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,363/barrel) rose 37.3 per cent. The contract's peak last week was ₹8,518, the highest price since August 2022. Year-to-date, crude oil futures price in MCX is up by a staggering 60.4 per cent.

The conflict in the Middle East and the consequent closure of the Strait of Hormuz, through which about 20 per cent of the global oil flows, triggered the rally. Now that Iraq and Kuwait have started to curb oil output, the upside looks to have more fuel left.

Nevertheless, the prices can remain volatile as the energy commodity is likely to react to every news regarding the con-



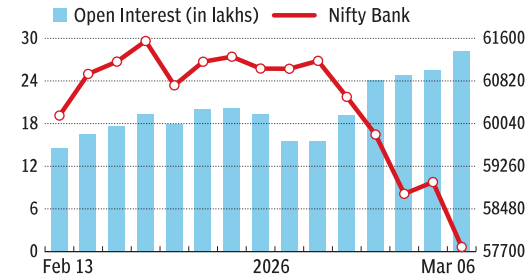
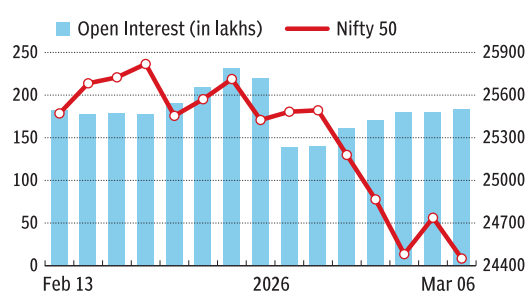
flict. So, traders should stay very cautious.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹8,363)
Crude oil futures (March) moved above barriers at ₹7,000 and ₹8,000 last week. The rally appears very strong and there are no signs yet of cooling. However, there is a chance for a corrective decline to ₹8,000 or ₹7,500.

Post this dip, the contract might resume the upswing to hit ₹10,000. On the back of this, there might be a decline. But how the contract will react to ₹10,000 is uncertain now.

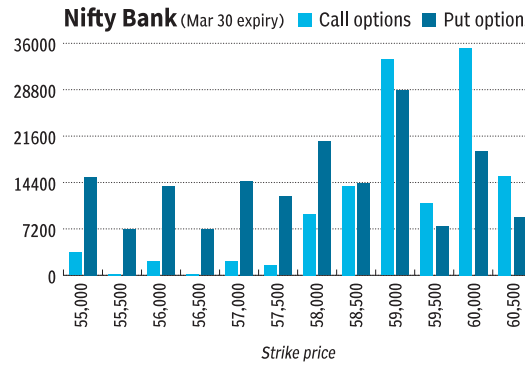
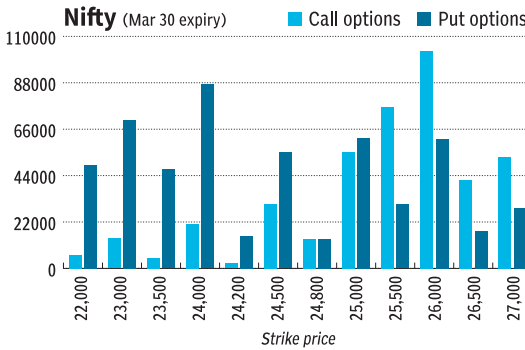
Trade strategy: Buy crude oil futures if the price dips to ₹7,700. Target and stop-loss can be ₹9,500 and ₹7,000 respectively. Risk-averse traders can avoid this trade.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.14** | Nifty Bank **0.79** (as on Mar 6)



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Mar 6	Weekly change %	As on Mar 6	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	30320	-16	227692	28
Future Index Short	204611	27	113601	35
Net Futures	-174291	40	114091	23
Index Call options Long	594054	-14	2963862	-21
Index Call options Short	768499	-1	2715835	-25
Net Call options	-174445	105	248027	78
Index Put options Long	939305	17	1819111	-4
Index Put options Short	486290	16	2451839	-1
Net Put Options	453015	18	-632728	5

FII's have added net short on index futures and increased net long on index puts. They have also increased net short on index calls. These factors indicate strong bearish bias.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Mar 6)				
MAZDOCK	2,471.90	11.1	121.7	73.0
INDIGO	4,404.10	-8.8	186.5	61.3
LT	3,949.80	-7.7	301.5	61.3
OIL	484.50	0.1	443.7	52.8
FEDERALBNK	286.50	-4.5	1320.1	37.2
FALL (as on Mar 6)				
APLAPOLLO	2,152.80	-3.7	68.6	-11.2
WAAREEENER	2,628.30	-3.0	90.6	-8.5
INDIANB	939.40	-5.2	148.5	-6.5
CHOLAFIN	1,626.30	-6.0	219.8	-4.4
SAMMAANCAP	142.40	-5.0	1461.0	-3.8

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Mar 9)

SAIL	SAMMAANCAP
------	------------

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Mar 6)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Mar	339.9 (8.7)	4,247 (-6)	Short covering
COPPER	31-Mar	1,197.2 (-2.1)	16,046 (-4)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOIL	19-Mar	8,363.0 (37.3)	17,890 (16)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	19-Mar	8,363.0 (37.2)	21,875 (62)	Long build-up
GOLD	2-Apr	161,634.0 (-0.3)	7,383 (-11)	Long unwinding
GOLDGUINEA	31-Mar	132,366.0 (0.5)	15,318 (7)	Long build-up
GOLDM	3-Apr	161,734.0 (-0.2)	40,989 (32)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	31-Mar	16,647.0 (0.6)	204,687 (7)	Long build-up
GOLDTEN	31-Mar	162,621.0 (0.2)	30,162 (8)	Long build-up
LEAD	31-Mar	189.1 (-0.3)	525 (-3)	Long unwinding
NATURALGAS	26-Mar	295.6 (12.7)	18,002 (-24)	Short covering
SILVER	5-May	268,285.0 (-5.1)	6,171 (2)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Apr	274,625.0 (-3.9)	14,553 (13)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Apr	274,796.0 (-3.8)	50,055 (18)	Short build-up
ZINC	31-Mar	323.9 (-0.8)	4,025 (1)	Short build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Mar 6)				
USDINR	25-Mar	91.86 (0.8)	2,318,671 (87)	Long build-up
EURINR	25-Mar	106.52 (-1.2)	27,705 (6)	Short build-up
GBPINR	25-Mar	122.77 (-0.1)	27,094 (31)	Short build-up
JPYINR	25-Mar	58.67 (-0.2)	86 (153)	Short build-up

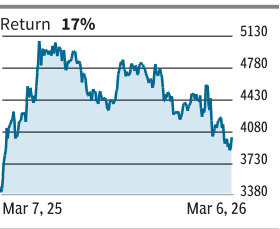
F&O Strategy

Buy HAL put

KS Badri Narayanan

The short-term outlook for the stock of Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) (₹4,023.70) remains negative. Immediate support levels are at ₹3,865 and ₹3,315. A close below the latter will change even the long-term outlook to negative.

Resistance levels are ₹4,250 and ₹4,675. A close above the latter will trigger a fresh rally on the stock. But we expect the stock to remain volatile in the short-term with negative bias.



F&O trends: HAL March stock futures closed at ₹4,030.60 on Friday against the spot price of ₹4,023.70. Open interest moved up from 11.80 lakh shares to 1.02 crore shares in the last 15 days as HAL remained volatile. Option trading indicates the stock could move between ₹3,800 and ₹4,500.

Strategy: Consider buying HAL 3950-put. As this contract's premium is ₹104.10 now and the market lot is 150 shares, this strategy would cost ₹15,615. This would be the maximum loss in this trade. Profits can be considerable if HAL falls sharply.

We advise traders to keep the initial stop-loss at ₹75, which can be shifted to ₹100, if the stock opens on a flat to negative note on Monday. Traders can aim for a target of ₹145 with trailing stop-losses.

Follow-up: We had advised going short on Angel One last week. The stock provided profit opportunities. Those who have not booked profits can exit.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

Trading volume vs open interest

bl. research bureau

When it comes to trading, liquidity is a critical prerequisite i.e., the derivative contracts of stocks /commodities that are more liquid are preferred for trading so that entries and exits can be executed with ease.

Trading volume and Open Interest (OI) are the metrics that can tell us about the liquidity. Not only liquidity, but these are also good gauges of the market sentiment and can help us understanding the direction and the strength of a trend. But often there is a confusion over the difference between volume and OI and how they are measured. Here, we look at difference.

Volume measures the number of contracts being exchanged between buyers and sellers in a particular



trading session i.e., every transaction is added.

But OI is the number of contracts that are outstanding at that time and they are added and subtracted based on whether the contract is created new or liquidation of contracts that are already open.

For example, suppose Trader A buys 10 option contracts of a stock from Trader B. Post this transaction, both volume and OI will be 10.

But if Trader A sells back 5 contracts to Trader B, the volume will go up to 15 whereas the OI will drop to 5. So, the key difference is that OI will go up only if new contracts are created whereas trading volume will go up irrespective of opening or a closing transaction.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 and Sensex fell about 2.9 per cent each. The Nifty Bank index on the other hand was beaten down by 4.5 per cent last week. The US-Iran war has triggered this sell-off in equity markets. The ongoing war can continue to weigh on the market sentiment. As such the Indian benchmark indices can fall more from here.

However, on the charts, strong long-term supports are coming up. We expect the support to halt this fall and trigger a reversal. We reiterate that this fall will be giving us a very good long-term buying opportunity.

FPIs SELL
The Foreign Portfolio Investors sold heavily last week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$2.29 billion. The FPIs can continue to sell more as the war situation is unlikely to ease soon.

NIFTY 50 (24,450.45)
Short-term view: The outlook is negative. Resistances are at 24,900 and 25,000. A higher resistance is around 25,300.

Nifty can fall to 24,000 from here. A break below 24,000 can drag it further down to 23,500 in the short term. But thereafter, we expect the index to reverse higher and go back up to 25,000.

Nifty has to surpass 25,300 in order to bring back the earlier bullishness into the picture.

Medium-term view: We retain our broader bullish view in spite of the recent fall. We reiterate that 24,000-23,500 will be a strong support. As long as the Nifty stays above this support, there is no danger for the broader uptrend.

So, we continue to retain our view of the Nifty targeting 27,500-28,000 in the medium term and 30,000-31,000 in the long term. Our bullish view will go wrong only if Nifty declines below 23,500. In that case, the downside will open up for an extended fall to 22,000 and even lower.

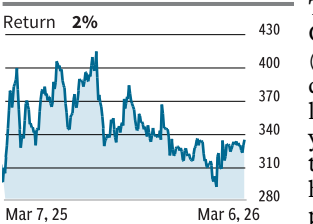
NIFTY BANK (57,783.25)
Short-term view: Last week, we had expected the support at 59,100 to hold and the Nifty Bank index to bounce back from there. That view has gone wrong.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

International Gemmological Institute (India) (₹335.30)

Forms inverted head and shoulder

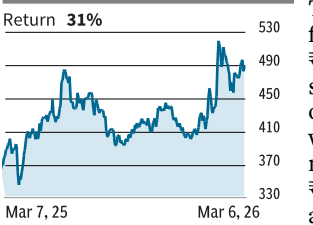


The stock of International Gemmological Institute (India) Limited (IGIL) saw a decline in price between July last year and January this year. However, for more than a month now, the scrip has seen some increase in price. Notably, the price action since November

shows an inverted head and shoulder pattern. We expect the stock to soon break out of the neckline of the pattern at ₹340 and embark on a rally to ₹390. A bullish crossover between 21- and 50-day moving averages has also occurred, strengthening the bullish case. Buy at ₹335 and ₹320. Stop-loss can be ₹300. On a rally to ₹370, alter the stop-loss to ₹340. Exit at ₹390.

Oil India (₹484.55)

Builds a base

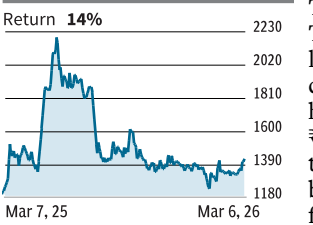


The stock of Oil India formed a good base between ₹390 and ₹400 over the last seven months. On the back of this, it rallied in the recent weeks. While the scrip is now facing a resistance at ₹520, the price action shows a clear bullish bias.

Therefore, we expect the share price of Oil India to surpass ₹520 soon. Once this happens, the stock can establish a rally to ₹700. Hence, participants can consider buying the stock now at ₹484 and accumulate if the price dips to ₹455. Place stop-loss at ₹380. When the price reaches ₹580, trail the stop-loss to ₹530. Revise the stop-loss to ₹600 when the stock hits ₹650. Book profits at ₹700.

Zen Technologies (₹1,425.75)

Strong bullish engulfing seen



The stock of Zen Technologies, since August last year, has largely been charting a sideways trend. It has been oscillating between ₹1,300 and ₹1,500. Although there has not been a breakout yet, the scrip formed a strong bullish engulfing candlestick

pattern on the weekly chart. Given the strength of last week's rally, we anticipate a breakout of ₹1,500 soon. The stock can appreciate to ₹1,900 over the medium-term. Therefore, participants can go long now at ₹1,425 and accumulate at ₹1,340. Place stop-loss at ₹1,200. When the stock moves up to ₹1,650, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,500. On a rally to ₹1,800, raise the stop-loss to ₹1,700. Exit at ₹1,900.

Battle-weary

INDEX OUTLOOK. Nifty, Sensex, Nifty Bank can fall more. But long-term supports have the potential to halt the drop

LONG-TERM SUPPORTS

- Nifty 50: 24,000, 23,500
- Sensex: 76,000, 75,500
- Nifty Bank: 54,000, 53,500

Immediate support is now at 57,500. Below that, 56,900 is the next support. We can expect a fall to 56,900 this week.

A bounce can take the Nifty Bank index back up to 59,000 again. That in turn will give some relief.

But a break below 56,900 will increase the downside pressure and drag the index down to 56,000 or even lower. So, the price action around 56,900 will need a very close watch this week.

Medium-term view: Crucial supports are at 56,000 and 54,000-53,500. It is not very clear as of now whether the current fall will halt at 56,000 itself or extend to 54,000-53,500.

But as long as the index stays above 53,500, there will not be any disruption in the broader uptrend.

As such, we continue to retain our bullish view of seeing a rise to 64,000-65,000 in the medium

Nifty 50 can fall more



term and 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the index declines below 53,500.

SENSEX (78,918.90)

Short-term view: Contrary to our expectation, Sensex has declined sharply below the support level of 80,100.

Resistances are now at 79,500, 80,200 and 80,700. Sensex can fall to 77,000 from here. A bounce thereafter will give some relief and take it higher to 80,000 or even higher.

The downside can extend up

to 76,000-75,500 if Sensex fails to bounce back from around 77,000

Medium-term view: Strong support is in the 76,000-75,500 region. A fall beyond 75,500 might be difficult.

A strong bounce from this support zone will keep the broader uptrend intact.

For now, we retain our view of the Sensex targeting 89,000-90,000 in the medium term and 98,000-99,000 in the long term. Considering the recent sharp fall, the aforementioned rise is going to take much more time than anticipated earlier.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (21,181.80)

The support at 21,000 seems to be holding well after the fall below 21,500 last week. The Nifty Midcap 150 index touched a low of 20,850 and has bounced back from there. Crucial short-term supports are at 20,850 and 20,750. If the index manages to sustain above this support, a rise back to 21,800-22,000 is possible in the coming weeks.

But a break below 20,750 can increase the downside pressure. It can then drag the Nifty Midcap 150 index down to 20,000.

As mentioned last week, 20,000 is a strong long-term support and is likely to hold well. So, the fall to 20,000 can be a very good buying opportunity.

As long as the index stays above 20,000, there is no change in the bullish view. We retain the view of the Nifty Midcap 150 index rising to 26,000-26,500 in the medium term and 28,000-28,500 in the long term. A strong break above 22,800 will clear the way for this rally.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (15,422.20)

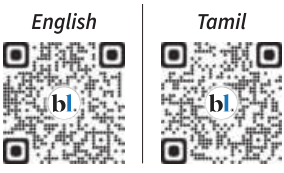
The crucial support level of 15,000 is holding well. The Nifty Smallcap 250 index made a low of 15,140 and has risen back from there. If the index manages to sustain above 15,000, then a rise to 16,000-16,500 can be seen in the short term.

In case the index declines below 15,000, the next strong long-term support is around 14,000. A fall beyond 14,000 is unlikely. So, if a fall to 14,000 is seen, then that is going to give us a very good long-term buying opportunity.

As long as the Nifty Smallcap 250 index stays above 14,000, a rise to 22,500-23,000 over the long term cannot be ruled out. A decisive rise above 18,300 can open the doors for this rally.

bl.portfolio video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week



War to sway US stocks as inflation adds wrinkle

GLOBAL VIEW. US-Israel campaign against Iran consuming markets

Reuters
New York

Investors will seek signs in the coming week of how sprawling the war in the Middle East will become and how much it will disrupt energy supplies, as they chew over fresh inflation data.

A US-Israeli campaign against Iran that entered its seventh day on Friday was consuming markets, with a jump in oil prices headlining volatility across assets US stocks swung sharply following the Middle East escalation, leaving the benchmark S&P 500 down 2% for the week. The Choe Volatility Index, Wall Street's most-watched gauge of investor anxiety, on Friday hit its highest level in nearly a year.

Compounding woes for stocks was Friday's weak US jobs report. The data for February showed a surprise drop in payrolls and the unemployment rate rising to 4.4 per cent.

Investors were balancing the historic tendency for equities to rebound in the wake of major global developments against a lack of clarity about the Iran situation. "This is a very big event and it seems incredibly uncertain where it's headed," said Rick Meckler, partner at Cherry Lane Investments. "To some extent, it's left investors as neither sellers nor buyers."

OIL PRICES

One focal point for markets was the surge in energy prices stemming from the conflict and its significance for inflation and economic output. The fighting has paralysed shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, a key artery for around a fifth of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas supply.

Brent crude on Friday topped \$90 a barrel, up from \$70 before the weekend strikes. Higher oil prices can dampen the outlook for equities in several ways, including by translating into higher gasoline prices that weaken consumer spending.



● DROP IN PAYROLLS

Compounding woes for stocks was Friday's weak US jobs report

In the near term, Michael Arone, chief investment strategist at State Street Investment Management, said changes in oil prices will be "a good barometer for whether risk assets will do well or they will do poorly." Oil breaching \$100 a barrel, he said, would be a psychological milestone that "would spook markets more." Even with the weekly decline, the S&P 500 remained just over 3 per cent from its all-time closing high set in late January. Expectations of a solid economic backdrop and strong corporate earnings growth this year have supported stocks, countering worries about artificial-intelligence-driven disruptions and private credit. Heading into next week, "developments in the Middle East will move really all financial markets," said Dominic Pappalardo, chief multi-asset strategist for Morningstar Wealth.

Inflation data will also be in Wall Street's spotlight. The consumer price index for February is due on Wednesday, following a cooler-than-expected January report for the closely watched infla-

tion measure. CPI for February is expected to show a 0.2 per cent increase on a monthly basis, according to a Reuters poll. Investors said markets may discount any report that is tame, because it covers a period almost entirely before the Middle East conflict. But a surprise spike in inflation could be particularly problematic. "If we get upside surprises to the inflation data next week, that could further fuel fears about inflation expectations rising and that would be bad for markets," Arone said. "The concern is that higher oil prices will only feed into higher inflation dynamics going forward."

RATE CUTS

Such worries about energy-induced higher inflation have contributed to investors pushing back their estimate for the Federal Reserve's next interest-rate cut, although the weak jobs data on Friday revived easing expectations somewhat.

Market-based expectations for a cut of at least 25 basis points at the Fed's June meeting stood at 45 per cent late on Friday, according to LSEG data. After the central bank lowered rates last year to shore up a weakening labour market, hopes for further easing this year of about two standard quarter-percentage-point cuts have been a crucial part of the bull case for stocks.

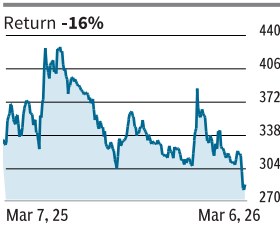
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K
bl.research bureau

I have shares of Rail Vikas Nigam Ltd (RVNL). My purchase price is ₹359. Should I continue to hold or exit?

Charu Nethra M

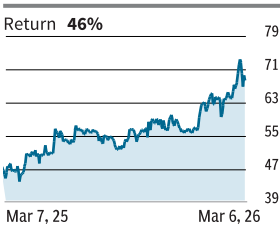


RVNL (₹290): The trend is down since mid-July 2024. The fall below ₹300 this week confirms a descending triangle on the chart. This is a continuation pattern, and it indicates that the downtrend has resumed. The region between ₹300

and ₹305 will be a very good resistance now. RVNL share price can fall to ₹250 from here initially. A corrective bounce thereafter to ₹270 or ₹300 cannot be ruled out. However, the upside will be capped at ₹300. An eventual break below ₹250 can then drag the share price down to ₹190-180 in the coming months. It is better to exit the stock and accept the loss now rather than waiting, with the hope of a trend reversal.

I have Bank of Maharashtra shares. My average price is ₹51. What is the long-term outlook?

Muhammad Ramzan

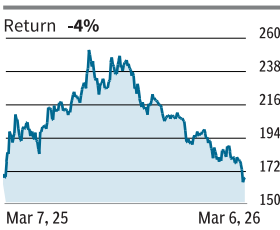


Bank of Maharashtra (₹71): The stock has been in a strong uptrend since March 2020. Intermediate corrections have not disrupted the broader uptrend. The rise since March 2020 is also happening inside a bull channel. Intermediate

support is around ₹57. The channel support is at ₹46. From a long-term perspective, Bank of Maharashtra share price has potential to target ₹150 in a year or two. You can keep a stop-loss at ₹49 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss up to ₹58 when the price goes up to ₹86. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹72 and ₹105 when the price touches ₹95 and ₹120 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹145. You can also consider buying more if a dip to ₹60 happens.

I have bought shares of ITC Hotels at ₹211. What is the outlook?

Krishna Hegde, Mysore

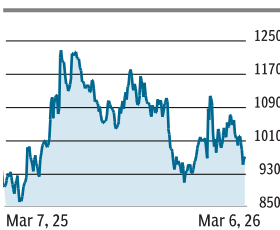


ITC Hotels (₹165): The trend is down and strong since September 2025. Within that, the price action since mid-October last year has been in a bear channel. There is no sign of a trend reversal as of now. Strong resistance is in the ₹185-190 region.

The channel resistance is also poised in this region. A strong break above ₹190 is needed to see some relief and trigger a rise to ₹200. A subsequent rise above ₹200 is needed to confirm a bullish trend reversal. That would need a strong positive trigger. But that looks less likely. Immediate support is in the ₹160-158 region. A bounce from here can trigger a corrective rise to ₹175-177. It is better to exit the stock now and accept the loss.

I am holding Maithan Alloys shares. I am planning to accumulate now. What's the long-term outlook for the stock.

Sateesh



Maithan Alloys (₹967): Without knowing your purchase price, it is difficult to suggest for accumulation. However, you can take a call based on our view as follows. The stock is stuck in a sideways range of

₹766-1,358 for more than three years. A breakout on either side of ₹766-1,358 will only determine the next leg of move. A break below ₹766 will be bearish for a fall to ₹550-530. On the other hand, a decisive break above ₹1,358 can take the price higher to ₹2,000-2,050. You can consider two options. One exit now no matter whether you are in profit or loss. Second is to keep a stop-loss at ₹720 and hold the stock. In this case you can exit at ₹2,030 or ₹720, whichever comes first.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all!" So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

- 1 Solar Industries India**
- 2 Kirloskar Oil Engines**
- 3 Natco Pharma**
- 4 Anand Rathi Wealth**
- 5 Astral**

Last week's prize winner
Ilankathir

Last week's winning stock
Finolex Cables

Closing price (Feb 27)
₹914.30

Closing price (Mar 6)
₹969.20

Return:
6 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, declined about 2.9 per cent each last week. BSE Capital Goods and BSE Healthcare were the top performers, delivering 0.2 per cent and -0.8 per cent, respectively. BSE Realty and BSE Oil & Gas were the worst performers, falling 4.9 per cent and 4.8 per cent, respectively.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	21.4	21.7	34.7	15.4	53.2	60.7	34.3	38.6	22.2	20.8	9.3	32.3	12.1	36.3	26.0
P/BV	3.3	4.2	6.6	2.3	13.9	15.7	7.6	6.6	6.1	3.8	1.7	4.4	2.4	4.6	7.7
Dividend Yield	1.3	1.2	1.2	1.0	0.5	0.5	1.5	0.5	2.8	1.3	2.4	1.2	2.3	0.4	2.2
Weekly Return (%)	-2.9 ▼	-2.9 ▼	-3.9 ▼	-4.6 ▼	0.2 ▲	-3.1 ▼	-2.5 ▼	-0.8 ▼	-1.8 ▼	-2.0 ▼	-4.8 ▼	-1.4 ▼	-2.6 ▼	-4.9 ▼	-1.2 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-5.0 ▼	-5.8 ▼	-1.9 ▼	-3.6 ▼	3.7 ▲	1.3 ▲	-2.0 ▼	3.1 ▲	-21.3 ▼	1.2 ▲	-0.7 ▼	3.3 ▲	2.1 ▲	-9.2 ▼	-16.5 ▼
Annual Return (%)	8.5 ▲	6.2 ▲	27.4 ▲	17.0 ▲	20.4 ▲	5.1 ▲	-3.0 ▼	9.7 ▲	-22.1 ▼	31.5 ▲	18.2 ▲	11.0 ▲	28.0 ▲	-9.6 ▼	-12.0 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Y-High	Y-Low
360 ONE [1]	1064.9	29.0	36.7	4.6	202512	51.5	18.4	22.1	10.0	-3.4	14.3	20	12730	766.1
3M India	34312.6	542.7	63.2	18.0	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-8.6	39.8	0	0.38300	26800.1
A B B [2]	6065.9	78.8	77.0	16.4	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	-0.1	9.8	0.1	6299.4	4590.1
A B Real Estate	1231.4	-19.0	3.6	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-52.3	-317.9	-4.5	-0.2	10.0	2.5530	1185.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	455.0	24.0	19.0	2.9	202512	18.2	22.7	18.7	20.0	-1.2	11.4	2.8	547.8	388.9
Aditya Industries [5]	419.1	10.2	40.0	2.7	202512	25.8	221.7	13.3	1.6	-6.3	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2
Aditya Birla Fins.	1228.6	61.8	19.8	2.6	202512	12.4	25.4	14.2	-4.3	-0.9	3.2	238.4	21.4	3.9
Abbott India	27345.2	717.3	38.1	14.5	202512	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	3.2	45.0	0.035921	26000.0	
ACC	1501.3	134.0	11.2	1.4	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	4.7	-5.7	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1499.1
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	228.2	8.3	27.6	2.9	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	-3.4	7.4	2.8	324.3	17.2
Action Consts.Eng. [2]	878.9	35.5	24.8	5.5	202512	10.9	29.0	9.3	8.6	-0.7	0.0	1390.0	775.0	
Adani Energy Sol.	991.9	18.7	33.1	5.1	202512	15.4	-1.7	20.0	4.8	-1.9	10.1	1.2	1067.3	706.8
Adani Enterp. [1]	2038.8	28.7	71.0	4.4	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	-5.8	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1850.0
Adani Green	859.0	14.0	83.0	7.3	202512	7.6	-106.8	14.8	10.1	-9.4	9.4	6.4	1179.2	760.0
Adani Ports [2]	1476.8	54.8	26.9	4.0	202512	21.9	24.9	26.3	18.9	-2.9	14.0	0.9	1594.0	1041.1
Adani Power [2]	138.9	5.9	23.4	4.0	202512	18.9	18.9	12.1	9.9	-1.2	11.7	18.2	94.4	
Adani Total Gas [1]	482.5	5.8	82.7	11.8	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	-5.8	17.4	0.4	79.4	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	924.3	35.3	26.2	7.5	202512	7.4	21.0	12.0	11.8	3.7	35.5	0.0	974.7	562.5
Aditya Birla Fins.	62.5	6.2	1.2	202512	19.9	-215.9	8.7	4.5	-6.8	0.0	1.3	107.7	58.0	
Aditya Birla Cap.	326.6	13.6	24.1	2.7	202512	27.4	40.5	13.0	-3.5	-5.1	9.5	4.4	369.3	194.9
Aegis Logistics [1]	664.4	21.9	30.3	3.9	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	-3.5	14.5	0.9	946.5	639.5
Aether Industri.	1011.0	16.9	60.0	5.8	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	5.5	9.7	0.1	1085.5	723.2
Affcons Infrastr.	282.9	13.9	20.4	1.9	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-19.7	-1.1	14.4	0.6	496.9	271.8
AIA [2]	1351.5	65.2	13.0	1.7	202512	12.2	42.9	36.2	-2.7	-3.7	15.6	0.1	2186.8	1324.1
AIA Engineering [2]	3674.5	124.8	29.4	4.7	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	-4.0	31.0	0.1	4200.0	3000.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	299.0	81.2	36.8	8.7	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	-0.1	32.0	0.0	352.2	202.1
Akzo Nobel	2768.6	83.0	33.4	5.6	202512	-13.6	12.5	-7.0	12.1	-5.7	39.1	0.1	3909.3	2649.1
Alkermis Pharma [2]	219.2	11.4	19.4	1.6	202512	10.8	21.7	11.0	11.8	-0.2	11.0	1.8	215.4	89.9
Alkem Lab. [2]	5540.1	200.9	27.6	5.0	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	-1.7	20.0	0.1	5913.0	4609.5
Alkyl Amines [2]	1384.0	35.3	39.2	4.9	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	1.2	-6.6	18.2	0.0	2448.8	137.6
Allied Blenders [2]	474.3	9.6	49.5	8.5	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	-0.1	21.0	0.9	720.0	278.9
Alstom [2]	13.5	0.5	24.1	4.8	202512	-0.7	-17.9	-12.8	21.6	-5.5	0.0	2.25	3.1	1
Amara Raja Ener.	807.5	37.4	21.6	1.9	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	-4.6	15.6	0.0	1108.7	781.1
Amber Enterp.	7870.4	60.6	119.2	7.6	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	-1.3	13.5	0.8	8625.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cement [2]	466.7	15.7	29.8	2.1	202512	9.2	89.9	16.4	-8.7	-6.7	12.7	0.0	625.0	465.4
Amara Rathw. Wm. [2]	319.2	40.4	7.4	1.2	202512	18.2	29.7	13.8	29.4	-0.8	16.8	0.1	332.9	158.6
Anant Raj [2]	489.3	14.6	33.4	3.2	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	-7.6	10.9	0.1	744.1	366.2
Angel One [1]	219.7	8.5	26.0	3.4	202512	5.8	-4.6	-14.6	-42.5	-0.6	25.8	0.7	328.3	194.2
Apur Inds.	10394.7	246.9	42.1	8.6	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	-22.8	-7.0	32.6	0.1	11641.8	4270.0
B PCL [2]	391.7	27.6	6.1	78.3	202512	17.1	20.9	12.2	4.1	-1.2	11.5	0.2	2300.0	1304.6
Apollo Hospitals [5]	7723.0	126.3	61.1	12.2	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	-1.2	17.5	0.6	8099.0	6180.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	439.9	23.0	19.1	1.8	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	-3.1	10.9	0.3	540.0	368.0
Apus Value Hou. [2]	228.1	17.8	12.8	2.5	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	-6.6	15.1	1.5	364.9	225.0
Arka India [2]	629.5	12.3	67.4	5.7	202512	-4.0	32.8	5.3	-59.7	-8.7	13.1	0.9	1073.0	576.4
Ashok Leyland [1]	194.6	6.2	31.5	9.1	202512	23.6	13.2	13.4	30.1	-3.7	14.6	0.9	215.4	89.9
Asian Paints [1]	2279.8	42.6	53.6	11.2	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	-4.1	24.4	0.1	2385.5	2175.0
Aster DM Health.	673.0	7.0	95.9	8.3	202512	12.9	10.1	8.5	38.5	3.2	11.6	0.5	73.0	32.0
Astral [1]	1689.6	65.2	16.1	1.2	202512	17.6	25.0	13.2	5.2	1.2	28.1	0.0	1705.0	1222.0
Astrazenchem Phar. [2]	8740.1	83.2	105.0	7.4	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	-24.1	-2.2	22.9	0.0	10505.0	6501.6
Ather Energy [1]	67.4	-16.9	9.5	202512	50.2	-140.2	50.9	25.0	-5.4	0.0	1.1	790.0	287.3	
Atul	6420.1	203.8	11.8	3.2	202512	11.1	47.8	13.3	42.9	-3.3	12.8	0.0	7193.0	4882.0
AU Small Finance	964.1	30.9	31.2	4.0	202512	14.9	26.3	22.3	13.6	0.6	0.0	0.0	1038.8	506.7
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1231.6	60.8	20.3	2.0	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	-0.8	14.2	0.2	1278.0	994.0
Autum Invest [1]	432.2	48.8	10.1	2.3	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	-10.3	29.7	0.1	683.5	271.2
Avenue Super.	3877.1	44.0	88.1	11.0	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	-5.0	0.8	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3476.3
AVL Agra Busine. [1]	177.2	7.4	24.0	2.3	202512	10.5	-30.0	21.8	-19.5	-6.2	19.8	0.3	291.3	177.0
Axis Bank [2]	1315.9	84.5	15.6	2.0	202512	4.8	4.0	4.5	-6.8	-4.9	0.0	0.0	1413.3	999.4

BHEL [2]	258.9	2.3	110.7	3.7	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	-2.2	3.2	0.4	305.9	188.0
B PCL [2]	352.7	57.6	6.1	1.6	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	-8.6	15.7	0.7	31.9	254.3
Bajaj Auto	9812.7	319.9	30.7	8.0	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	-1.6	28.1	0.2	11086.6	7088.3
Bajaj Finance [1]	950.9	29.3	32.5	5.7	202512	18.4	-2.1	20.7	14.0	-4.7	11.4	3.8	210.5	810.2
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1869.2	62.1	30.1	3.9	202512	24.9	11.6	15.6	15.9	-6.2	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1750.1
Bajaj Holdings [2]	10549.2	660.2	16.0	1.7	202512	127.6	15.3	-34.1	-2.2	-2.3	11.5	0.0	114873.2	21046.0
Bajaj Housing	84.2	3.0	28.2	3.3	202512	18.2	23.2	18.9	27.1	-3.3	9.5	4.7	137.0	81.4
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2253.2	67.9	33.2	4.2	202512	6.9	15.0	2.6	-26.0	-5.8	17.9	0.3	2815.4	2020.1
Balarampur Chini [1]	480.8	22.2	21.7	2.5	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	2.3	11.1	0.6	72.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank	183.0	6.3	29.3	1.2	202512	-0.9	51.8	0.0	-59.4	0.5	0.0	0.0	19.5	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	295.3	37.6	7.8	0.9	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-4.7	-8.3	0.0	0.0	325.6	201.1
Bank of India	195.7	22.4	7.1	0.9	202512	4.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	-9.4	0.0	0.0	178.5	92.8
Bank of Maha	70.1	8.4	8.3	1.7	202512	16.1	27.4	19.3	22.9	-6.3	0.0	0.0	77.0	38.1
BASF India	3437.8	44.3	40.8	3.9	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	-0.5	17.9	0.1	5418.2	2906.9
Bata India [5]	743.8	14.9	49.8	6.3	202512	2.8	9.0	-0.6	-23.4	-5.7	14.6	0.0	1300.1	730.9
Bayer Crop Sci.	1603.5	149.2	30.8	6.6	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	-1.5	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.9
BEML Ltd. [1]	4653.9	29.9	55.3	4.9	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	-1.6	11.7	0.1	2437.1	1213.6
Berger Paints [1]	442.7	8.6	46.1	8.2	202512	0.3	5.1	5.1	-1.7	-2.9	24.8	0.1	604.6	429.5
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1356.7	15.6	45.8	11.8	202512	-31.4	50.4	57.2	2.5	7.2	10.2	0.0	1065.6	1051.6
Bharti Airtel [1]	468.4	8.2	57.4	17.5	202512	29.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	5.4	36.9	0.0	473.3	252.3
Bharti Forge	178.3	5.3	48.4	11.8	202512	19.6	11.6	15.6	15.9	-6.2	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1750.1
Bharti Airtel [5]	1871.5	53.8	44.8	9.1	202512	19.6	12.1	25.0	58.0	-0.4	2.2	21.7	174.3	159.5
Bharti Hexacom [1]	1604.6	35.2	45.5	12.9	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	67.8	0.2	16.5	1.5	1051.0	1225.0
Bikaji Foods [1]	613.5	10.0	61.6	10.3	202512	13.2	117.6	13.9	-8.3	-3.8	18.4	0.2	820.9	605.7
Bilcoam [1]	390.5	5.1	77.3	1.7	202512	9.3	1733.6	14.4	5.9	0.2	6.9	0.8	425.5	295.3
Birla Corp.	74.2	11.1	14.1	1.4	202512	16.1	14.4	15.1	-15.2	-12.7	15.1	0.0	1537.2	633.5
Birlsoft Ltd [2]	37.22	17.5	21.3	2.8	202512	-1.1	22.7	-2.6	-1.6	-4.6	-20.8	0.0	473.8	320.2
BSL Internet. [1]	256.1	15.5	16.4	5.0	202512	43.6	34.8	47.6	41.9	-8.2	39.0	1.0	428.3	246.1
Blue Dart Express	5400.5	122.5	44.1	7.9	202512	6.9	30.1	1.1	5.7	-5.0	17.1	0.7	7224.4	5196.0
Blue Bird Transport	228.1	2.8	22.8	1.8	202512	19.4	20.4	20.4	20.4	20.4	20.4	20.4	157.2	63.3
Blue Star [2]	1948.3	26.0	75.0	12.9	202512	4.2	-2.0	9.5	-2.6	0.4	25.8	0.1	2266.7	1521.2
Bosch	33351.6	783.8	42.5	7.0	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	14.2	-8.4	20.5	0.0	41494.4	25938.8
Brambbles Solut. [2]	214.5	-3.0	2.3	2.3	202512	11.6	-772.0	12.4	-3.4	-1.1	0.0	0.4	438.7	207.2
Brimacombs Entorp.	11.0	0.1	21.4	0.6	202512	11.6	11.6	11.6	11.6	11.6	11.6	11.6	11.6	11.6
Britannia Inds. [1]	5985.0	100.3	59.7	38.6	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	-0.1	51.9	0.4	6337.0	4525.1

Her money, her rules

FINANCE DIARIES. This Women’s Day, voices across different generations tell *bl.portfolio* their own stories of money, discipline, doubt and growing financial confidence

**Anjana C. Shriram
Gayathri G**

As the world marks International Women’s Day on March 8, women in India are increasingly reshaping the country’s investing landscape — moving beyond household budgeting to actively building wealth and making strategic financial decisions.

Consider the spectrum: a 23-year-old legal executive investing

nearly 70 per cent of her salary in equities, and a 60-year-old education advisor who entered markets later in life but now manages her portfolio with confidence.

Their journeys reflect both progress and the persistent gaps in women’s financial participation.

Across generations, one insight stands out: for many women, financial security is less about absolute wealth and more about autonomy. It is about

building buffers against uncertainty, planning for longer life expectancy, and ensuring dignity in retirement.

According to India’s Sample Registration System (2019-23), women live on average 72.5 years, compared with 68.5 years for men, underscoring the need for stronger long-term financial planning.

Women’s participation in financial markets is rising but still limited. Data from the Association of Mutual Funds

in India (AMFI) show women accounted for around 25 per cent of India’s mutual fund investors as of March 2025. Meanwhile, figures from the National Stock Exchange of India indicate women make up nearly 25 per cent of individual investors, with States such as Maharashtra and Gujarat exceeding the national average.

Yet barriers remain — information gaps, delayed entry into markets,

career breaks, social pressures around spending, and perceptions about risk continue to shape women’s financial choices.

Still, the shift is unmistakable. Whether through cautious allocations to debt and gold, disciplined diversification, or bold equity bets, women are moving from saving to investing, from silence to active participation, and from dependence to deliberate financial design.

Maanya Sharma | 23
Legal Executive at a private firm

About your investing journey?
I’ve been inclined to save since childhood. It began with piggy banks and later a money box my father bought from Japan. In Class 11, I learnt about fixed deposits and invested my gift money through my father. During my first year of college — around Covid — I began exploring investing. I experimented with crypto and stocks while receiving about ₹5,000 a month and invested whatever I could. At 18, I formally started investing in stocks and crypto. While I incurred losses in crypto, my stock investments have done well. Stocks I bought in 2020 have grown significantly. Even small amounts can compound meaningfully over time — the magic of compounding is real.

Today I invest 60-70 per cent of my salary. Living at home without rent or food expenses allows me to save aggressively. Since I’m young and free of EMIs, I can afford to experiment. My portfolio is roughly 70 per cent equity, 15-20 per cent debt, and 10-15 per cent gold and silver.

Is it physical gold or ETF?
I own some gold coins, but most of my regular gold investments go into ETFs through auto-debits.

How do you keep yourself updated financially?
My father has been my biggest influence. I also read extensively. Books like *The Psychology of Money* by Morgan Housel and *Let’s Talk Money* by Monika Halan gave me practical insights into investing.

As a lawyer, I read newspapers daily. I’m also fortunate to have friends interested in financial planning. Observing both good and poor financial decisions has been instructive. For me, investing is like playing Test cricket — you don’t swing at every ball. You protect your wicket, stay patient and think long term. My aggression lies in high equity allocation, not speculative bets. I largely invest in large-cap stocks.

Any challenges?
The biggest challenge is understanding markets — the more you learn, the more you realise how much there is to know. Being young is my biggest advantage. Occasionally I divert money for travel or indulgences — I love travelling and sometimes splurge on my dog — but overall I haven’t faced major financial hurdles.



Shobana Raghavendran | 34
Homemaker

Financial security?
It means comfortably meeting household expenses, healthcare needs and children’s education while ensuring secure retirement years.

Investing rationale?
I prefer stable investments such as fixed deposits, recurring deposits, PPF, Sukanya Samridhi Yojana and real estate. I remain cautious about mutual funds and equities due to market volatility. I wasn’t very interested in gold earlier, but given the recent surge in prices, I sometimes feel I may have missed out.

Financial literacy?
I did Corporate Secretaryship and I discuss financial matters with my peers, and read newspapers.



Risk appetite?
Very low. Most stories I’ve heard about equities are negative, which makes me cautious.

Challenges?
I took a career break after childbirth. Currently my spouse, who works in financial services, handles most investment decisions.

Parvati Nair | 33
Actor

What does financial security mean to you?
Financial security means freedom and dignity — the ability to make life choices based on what feels right rather than financial necessity.

In cinema, income can be cyclical and unpredictable, so I’ve always believed in creating a strong safety net.

Financial security also means being able to support my family, meet responsibilities without stress, and pursue meaningful work without accepting every opportunity purely for money.

Your investing journey?
My investment approach is diversified and long term. I prefer spreading investments across asset classes rather than relying on a single avenue.

My portfolio includes equities (60-70 per cent) for growth, debt instruments for stability, gold as a

hedge, and real assets such as real estate for long-term security.

The goal is to balance growth with stability while managing risk responsibly.

How do you stay updated?
I make a conscious effort to keep learning by reading about markets and following credible financial platforms.

My husband is financially savvy and a great sounding board, so we often discuss investment decisions and long-term planning.

Those conversations, along with my own reading and experience, have



strengthened my understanding of investing.

Risk appetite?
I’d describe it as balanced. I’m comfortable taking calculated risks for long-term growth but avoid speculation.

Understanding one’s temperament is crucial because markets will always fluctuate.

Challenges?
The unpredictability of the entertainment industry means income can vary, so financial planning must account for that.

Another challenge is the overwhelming volume of financial information today.

Usha Iyer | 61
Founder Principal, The Green School Bangalore

Financial security?
For me, financial security is about dignity, independence and continuity. Financial security meant maintaining stability during uncertainty. Ultimately, it is peace of mind backed by preparation.



diversified strategy:

- Equities for long-term growth
- Debt for stability
- Gold as a hedge
- Real assets for tangible long-term value

Capital preservation is as important as wealth creation.

Financial literacy?
I stay informed by reading financial newspapers, attending

seminars and consulting advisors.

Women must actively participate in financial decisions.

Risk appetite?
Calculated and measured — risks backed by research and planning.

Challenges?
Taking full financial responsibility after my husband’s passing was challenging. Structure — budgeting, documentation and professional advice — helped me manage that transition.

Saraswathi Kasturirangan | 56
Chairperson – HR & 3i Expert Committee, Bangalore Chamber of Industry & Commerce

Financial security?
It means having the flexibility to choose how I spend my time — whether in pro bono work, volunteering, travel or gardening — without compromising my lifestyle. It also means having passive income that comfortably covers expenses and contingencies.

Investing rationale?
My priorities have evolved with life stages. Early investments were largely in real assets and jewellery, partly influenced by social norms. I also invested in government

schemes such as PF and PPF.

Today my portfolio includes debt instruments, mutual funds, real assets and jewellery.

Financial literacy?
Over time I recognised the importance of diversification and began seeking inputs from wealth advisors. In hindsight, I wish I had done that earlier.

Risk appetite?
Moderate, with investments spread

across asset classes.

Challenges?
Early in one’s career, social spending often takes precedence over financial investments. Breaking that pattern requires conscious effort.

Insurance costs in later years also tend to be high, making structured financial planning more critical.



Uma Pendyala | 50
Head – Business Operations, SecurEyes Techno Services

Financial security?
It means being able to meet essential expenses comfortably while maintaining emergency funds, adequate insurance, retirement savings and responsible debt levels. It creates a predictable and less stressful life.



stability has always been important.

My allocation focuses on long-term wealth creation and passive income, with disciplined planning rather than speculation.

Financial literacy?
I treat it as a continuous learning process. I consult advisors but always evaluate recommendations independently. Awareness

evolves with life stages.

Risk appetite?
Calculated but cautious. Stability and peace of mind remain priorities.

Challenges?
I started investing later than I would have liked.

Early stock market decisions were influenced by quick gains, but experience taught me patience and research.

Building trust with a financial advisor was also initially difficult.

Nivedita Mukerjee | 60
Education advisor and mentor to leadership teams of educational institutions

What does financial security mean to you?
Financial security means not having to ask for money or justify how I spend it. It’s less about income levels and more about autonomy. If I must explain my spending choices, I wouldn’t feel financially secure. For me, it’s about independence and dignity.

Your investing journey and challenges?
Initially, I invested only in traditional instruments such as LIC, PPF and National Savings Schemes, influenced by my father’s government background. Information wasn’t easily accessible then, and that lack of exposure was a major hurdle. Although I always saved, I began investing actively much later. Among teachers I work with, the biggest barrier remains lack of information.

How do you update yourself?
I read extensively — books, articles and financial newspapers. Social media can be useful too, though filtering noise is essential.



Portfolio and risk appetite?
My portfolio began as 80:20 debt and equity, but has gradually moved to a 50:50 allocation. I would describe my risk appetite as moderate. I own one house for residence and have exited additional real estate investments. Around 7 per cent of my portfolio is in gold.

Kathakali Dutta | 23
Media professional

Financial security?
Financial security isn’t about being extremely wealthy but having enough stability and cushion to make long-term decisions without immediate financial pressure.

Investing rationale?
Equities are my primary driver for long-term growth. Debt instruments provide stability and liquidity, while gold acts as a hedge. Real assets are something I evaluate carefully because they require higher capital and have lower liquidity.

Financial literacy?
I stay informed by reading about economic trends, policy developments and market behaviour. Making investment decisions and reflecting on outcomes is also an important learning process.

Risk appetite?
Fairly high but calculated. I avoid impulsive decisions and focus on maintaining a balanced portfolio.

Challenges?
One challenge is navigating the sheer volume of information and opinions about markets. Another is maintaining discipline and a long-term perspective during market fluctuations.



Pushpa Murali | 61
Retired banker

Financial security?
Financial security means having minimal financial worries, irrespective of income levels.

Investing rationale?
I aim to maximise returns while minimising risk. My preference is for gold and real assets.

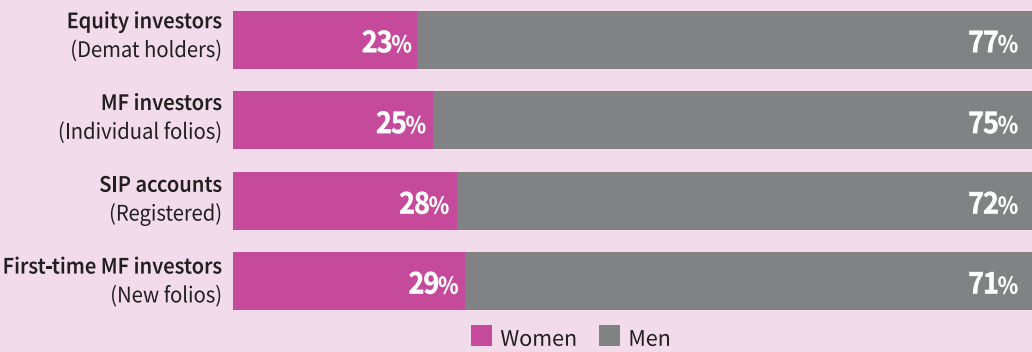


Financial literacy?
a banker, I regularly receive updates on investment opportunities from my bank.

Risk appetite?
Very low. I prefer low-risk avenues.

Challenges?
I did not face major challenges, largely because I had reliable advisors.

How & where they invest



Gold (Physical)
32.6% of women save through physical gold - compared with 25.8% of men



Informal Savings
18.7% of women rely on cash, chits and SHGs - double the share of men (9.4%)



Pension/Provident Fund
Just 14.2% of women have pensions or provident funds, versus 32.8% of men



Post Office Savings Schemes
22% of women use post-office savings schemes - versus 17.6% of men



Mutual Funds
Only 8.6% of women invest in mutual funds or equities - compared with 22.3% of men



Life Insurance (Traditional+ULIP)
Only 21.4% of women hold life insurance - compared with 29.1% of men



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	61.0	17092	1.7	0.5	7.8	13.9	11.3	14.5	0.42
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	108.9	76646	1.4	0.9	10.8	16.7	14.6	15.1	0.58
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	89.3	50107	1.5	0.7	11.3	17.6	16.4	15.4	0.63
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1123.2	39621	1.6	1.0	8.4	14.4	13.6	14.3	0.52
*****	JM Large Cap	150.4	444	2.4	0.9	9.1	14.1	12.3	11.7	0.42
*****	Kotak Large Cap	566.1	10864	1.7	0.6	11.2	14.4	12.2	13.5	0.44
*****	SBI Large Cap	91.8	54821	1.5	0.8	10.9	13.5	11.6	13.1	0.44
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	510.4	30392	1.6	1.0	8.9	14.0	12.3	13.0	0.45
***	Bandhan Large Cap	75.8	1980	2.0	0.9	11.8	16.1	12.5	13.4	0.42
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	217.3	2614	2.0	0.8	9.1	15.1	12.4	13.5	0.44
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	83.0	1444	2.1	0.6	10.0	13.9	12.2	13.6	0.43
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	996.6	7704	1.9	1.1	9.2	13.4	10.2	11.7	0.36
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	66.6	1666	2.0	0.7	10.0	15.7	12.9	13.1	0.44
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	109.7	40371	1.5	0.5	8.9	11.8	10.4	13.9	0.38
***	Tata Large Cap	496.5	2760	2.0	1.0	9.5	13.9	12.2	12.7	0.45
***	UTI Large Cap	262.9	12658	1.8	0.9	5.9	11.4	10.1	12.4	0.35
**	DSP Large Cap	459.8	7163	1.8	0.9	7.0	16.3	12.5	12.6	0.48
**	HSBC Large Cap	475.2	1885	2.1	1.3	12.0	14.6	11.3	13.4	0.37
**	LIC MF Large Cap	53.2	1422	2.2	1.1	7.3	10.6	9.0	11.2	0.30
**	Union Largecap	23.1	458	2.5	1.7	8.7	12.2	10.5	-	0.35
**	Axis Large Cap	58.9	32420	1.6	0.7	7.3	11.7	8.2	12.8	0.25
*	Groww Largecap	42.5	129	2.5	1.3	12.4	13.5	10.8	12.2	0.35
**	PGIM India Large Cap	326.8	570	2.4	0.9	7.9	10.0	8.7	10.8	0.28
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.5	740	2.3	0.6	8.0	13.3	11.2	-	0.39
-	Taurus Large Cap	155.9	51	2.6	2.3	10.2	15.8	11.9	11.0	0.35
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	132.6	13968	1.7	0.5	13.0	22.1	18.1	16.5	0.62
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	329.4	28240	1.6	0.8	10.5	18.6	16.9	15.5	0.61
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1001.5	27445	1.6	0.8	11.8	20.0	19.0	16.5	0.77
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	32.2	15287	1.7	0.6	11.8	18.8	14.8	-	0.46
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	104.4	3039	2.0	0.8	0.6	13.5	15.6	15.6	0.46
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	633.5	37497	1.6	0.7	14.8	17.4	16.7	15.9	0.64
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	178.6	5724	1.9	0.9	12.6	20.9	17.2	15.1	0.63
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	87.6	446	2.3	1.1	13.9	16.2	14.7	13.5	0.46
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	238.1	24644	1.6	0.6	5.3	14.6	12.5	15.9	0.42
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	610.5	17343	1.7	0.6	10.4	19.1	15.4	16.1	0.56
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	85.8	4442	1.8	0.4	12.2	17.6	14.6	15.3	0.48
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	95.1	8959	1.8	0.6	13.8	22.7	16.4	16.3	0.50
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	344.9	29991	1.6	0.6	15.5	18.5	15.9	16.5	0.56
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	148.6	42275	1.5	0.6	13.8	16.1	13.3	17.7	0.45
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1439.9	6751	1.9	1.2	11.8	19.8	16.1	13.8	0.56
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	179.9	3518	2.0	1.3	7.7	15.0	12.0	12.1	0.41
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.2	3045	1.9	0.6	7.9	16.8	13.6	15.2	0.46
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	84.5	6735	1.8	0.7	13.3	15.9	13.4	14.8	0.44
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	483.5	8123	1.8	0.7	2.5	11.1	11.1	13.4	0.42
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	890.1	5654	1.9	1.1	12.5	14.8	10.0	12.6	0.28
**	Navi Large & Midcap	33.9	302	2.3	0.5	7.8	11.7	11.9	13.5	0.40
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	26.5	4603	1.9	0.8	17.2	19.6	15.1	-	0.40
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1987.2	97452	1.3	0.7	12.5	20.3	19.3	17.5	0.79
*****	JM Flexicap	91.5	5152	1.8	0.6	3.0	18.3	16.4	17.0	0.53
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.9	133970	1.3	0.6	7.5	18.7	17.3	17.9	0.69
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.9	3133	1.9	0.4	12.9	17.8	14.8	15.6	0.49
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1582.7	19528	1.7	0.9	8.4	17.3	15.0	14.3	0.52
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	34.8	6022	1.8	0.5	9.2	11.8	11.2	14.2	0.35
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.4	2320	2.0	0.9	10.2	14.3	12.7	13.8	0.43
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1799.2	24700	1.7	0.9	14.2	17.4	13.6	15.0	0.46
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	203.2	7478	1.9	1.1	10.1	14.9	12.4	11.9	0.43
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	330.0	13327	1.7	0.6	10.9	14.3	12.2	14.9	0.43
***	DSP Flexi Cap	99.3	11989	1.8	0.9	8.5	15.7	12.3	15.0	0.41
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	209.8	5318	1.9	1.2	11.4	17.4	14.0	13.7	0.42
***	Kotak Flexicap	84.9	56479	1.4	0.6	15.2	16.5	13.0	14.9	0.45
***	SBI Flexicap	106.4	23148	1.7	0.8	8.5	12.4	10.7	13.1	0.38
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.5	3630	1.9	0.6	9.7	15.4	11.6	-	0.42
**	Axis Flexi Cap	25.7	12639	1.7	0.7	10.9	14.5	10.1	-	0.30
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	54.9	13180	1.7	0.8	0.4	19.3	11.3	12.9	0.35
**	Navi Flexi Cap	22.7	253	2.2	0.6	11.4	12.3	11.5	-	0.38
**	UTI Flexi Cap	290.8	22886	1.7	1.1	-0.5	8.7	6.4	12.0	0.18
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	94.4	1000	2.3	1.6	10.7	13.3	10.4	10.6	0.33
**	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.4	131	2.4	0.8	6.6	9.6	8.8	-	0.24
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	213.5	342	2.7	2.6	4.2	13.4	11.0	10.4	0.34
-	Quant Flexi Cap	93.7	6221	1.8	0.7	7.5	15.8	18.9	19.3	0.54
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	273.8	3048	2.0	0.9	7.5	17.0	15.5	14.6	0.47
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	778.4	15845	1.7	0.9	9.9	18.9	16.1	15.3	0.59
-	Invesco India Multicap	118.4	3934	1.9	0.7	1.5	15.0	13.4	14.0	0.41
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	34.8	6046	1.8	0.4	14.8	19.6	17.5	-	0.53
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	288.5	48809	1.5	0.7	11.5	20.3	19.7	16.1	0.70
-	Quant Multi Cap	563.5	7456	1.8	0.7	-0.4	9.7	14.0	16.9	0.39
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	366.2	2798	2.0	0.9	9.6	16.1	15.1	15.6	0.50
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	100.7	13802	1.7	0.4	17.7	24.7	20.3	19.2	0.62
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	194.7	92187	1.4	0.7	16.1	24.0	21.2	18.8	0.77
*****	Quant Mid Cap	190.5	7283	1.8	0.8	-2.1	13.0	18.0	15.7	0.53
*****	Invesco India Midcap	172.2	10058	1.7	0.5	18.0	25.3	19.7	18.6	0.58
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	33.3	4267	1.9	0.5	14.4	23.5	19.6	-	0.60
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	86.6	34432	1.6	0.8	-4.2	19.4	20.9	16.6	0.61
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4180.5	41727	1.5	0.7	18.1	24.9	21.2	19.3	0.69
***	Axis Midcap	111.0	30895	1.6	0.6	14.0	18.9	15.0	17.4	0.47
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	102.9	2282	2.0	0.5	14.9	20.2	16.7	16.3	0.56
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	313.2	6969	1.9	1.0	25.1	24.6	19.3	17.4	0.62
***	Kotak Midcap	133.0	59041	1.4	0.4	17.3	20.3	18.1	18.7	0.59
***	PGIM India Midcap	61.2	10751	1.7	0.5	8.9	12.5	14.3	16.0	0.46
***	SBI Midcap	227.5	22424	1.7	0.9	7.3	15.5	16.0	15.1	0.56
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1381.5	12917	1.7	0.9	17.1	23.5	18.4	16.0	0.59
***	Tata Mid Cap	431.8	5356	1.8	0.7	15.7	20.6	16.9	16.9	0.57
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	755.6	6041	1.9	1.0	10.8	18.4	16.2	14.3	0.53
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2613.2	12223	1.8	1.0	8.8	19.9	15.1	15.4	0.48
**	Taurus Mid Cap	111.4	123	2.5	1.9	6.5	13.8	12.6	15.4	0.38
**	UTI Mid Cap	220.2	11734	1.8	0.9	11.9	16.1	14.5	14.8	0.47
**	DSP Midcap	149.4	19047	1.7	0.8	16.0	19.4	13.4	15.9	0.42
**	HSBC Midcap	392.0	12175	1.7	0.7	21.3	23.6	17.6	17.2	0.49
**	LIC MF Midcap	27.4	337	2.5	1.4	6.9	19.1	13.6	-	0.40
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	157.6	65812	1.4	0.7	8.3	19.2	21.6	21.0	0.61
*****	Quant Small Cap	230.6	27384	1.6	0.8	2.8	17.1	23.1	17.9	0.58
*****	AXIS Small Cap	99.1	25517	1.6	0.6	7.5	16.3	18.1	18.2	0.59

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	42.5	1829	2.0	0.5	5.6	17.7	18.5	-	0.47
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	39.9	9009	1.7	0.4	13.1	22.5	20.7	-	0.58
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	186.9	16135	1.7	0.8	12.7	18.4	18.4	17.1	0.54
★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	128.8	36941	1.5	0.7	8.7	16.4	19.2	18.2	0.57
★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	80.9	8123	1.8	0.8	7.7	14.8	17.1	16.1	0.61
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	235.9	16368	1.7	0.6	4.0	13.3	14.7	17.0	0.45
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	242.2	3285	1.9	0.8	11.3	17.5	17.9	14.8	0.52
★★★★	Tata Small Cap	32.9	10761	1.7	0.4	-6.7	11.5	16.7	-	0.52
★★★★	Union Small Cap	48.5	1697	2.1	1.0	17.9	18.7	18.1	16.2	0.47
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	155.9	12764	1.8	1.0	5.4	16.7	17.8	15.6	0.51
★★	HSBC Small Cap	73.4	15029	1.7	0.7	4.5	15.2	19.4	18.5	0.51
★★	SBI Small Cap	155.6	34449	1.6	0.8	2.6	11.7	14.1	17.8	0.46
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	81.7	4778	1.9	0.9	12.3	16.7	13.5	13.5	0.38
★	LIC MF Small Cap	27.7	606	2.4	1.0	3.5	15.4	17.7	-	0.47
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	36.2	12671	1.7	0.5	7.9	14.7	18.5	-	0.57
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	41.2	5369	1.8	0.5	9.5	18.1	18.4	-	0.57
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
★★★★★	HSBC Value	110.2	14552	1.7	0.7	17.3	21.5	19.1	17.0	0.62
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	472.1	60353	1.5	1.0	12.1	19.1	19.3	16.3	0.88
★★★★	Bandhan Value	144.6	10104	1.8	0.7	7.9	16.0	17.2	16.5	0.61
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	220.7	8962	1.8	1.1	9.1	21.1	17.6	16.8	0.60
★★★★	HDFC Value	734.0	7487	1.8	1.0	13.8	18.4	15.5	14.8	0.54
★★★★	JM Value	88.9	885	2.3	1.1	2.6	17.2	15.9	16.9	0.50
★★★★	Templeton India Value	707.8	2265	2.1	0.9	9.6	16.4	16.6	15.3	0.61
★★★★	Union Value	27.9	367	2.5	1.3	13.0	17.3	14.9	-	0.53
★★★★	UTI Value	163.8	9787	1.8	1.2	8.1	17.1	14.3	14.5	0.53
★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	123.1	6246	1.9	1.0	11.1	18.9	15.4	12.9	0.44
★★	Tata Value	343.0	8819	1.8	0.8	10.6	18.0	15.5	16.0	0.54
★	LIC MF Value	24.5	203	2.5	1.4	15.1	15.0	13.0	-	0.37
★	Quantum Value	118.8	1151	2.1	1.1	2.7	14.8	12.3	12.4	0.50
-	Groww Value	25.8	66	2.3	0.9	10.0	15.1	12.3	10.9	0.44
-	Sundaram Value	214.6	1389	2.3	1.7	9.0	12.1	11.6	12.5	0.43
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
★★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	137.3	17223	1.6	0.7	9.7	18.5	15.7	16.5	0.59
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	355.5	11736	1.7	0.8	11.4	15.5	18.1	20.1	0.52
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	429.3	31862	1.6	0.9	8.1	21.9	18.3	15.6	0.69
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	150.5	7060	1.8	0.7	10.3	14.6	14.6	15.8	0.61
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	156.7	1374	2.0	0.8	9.8	16.4	14.6	16.6	0.41
★★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	171.7	8721	1.7	0.6	10.9	14.3	12.4	15.4	0.43
★★★★	HDFC ELSS Tax saver	1374.2	16749	1.7	1.1	10.0	19.2	18.3	15.1	0.78
★★★★	JM ELSS Tax Saver	45.7	216	2.4	1.0	5.3	16.7	14.0	16.0	0.45
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	47.8	26112	1.6	0.6	11.9	15.7	13.1	17.6	0.47
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	94.4	911	2.2	1.0	11.6	18.0	12.6	13.3	0.40
★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1411.6	6440	1.8	1.1	6.7	16.8	14.5	13.3	0.50
★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	911.8	14245	1.1	1.1	10.8	15.6	13.1	13.8	0.48
★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	112.4	6301	1.8	0.6	10.3	14.3	13.5	15.0	0.46
★★	Mahli Manu ELSS Tax Saver	27.5	938	2.2	0.6	8.2	12.9	12.7	-	0.45
★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	47.7	4188	1.8	0.7	11.3	20.5	16.3	16.5	0.41
★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	118.1	218	2.1	0.9	2.7	14.6	12.3	12.4	0.51
★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	495.4	1348	2.2	1.5	9.4	14.0	13.0	14.6	0.47
★★	Tata ELSS	44.2	4566	1.8	0.7	11.8	15.0	13.2	14.7	0.44
★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	62.9	870	2.3	1.3	1.4	14.1	13.3	13.4	0.46
★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	109.5	440	2.3	0.7	12.8	15.5	12.8	12.9	0.42
★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	130.2	3961	1.9	1.2	10.1	18.4	14.0	14.2	0.43
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	114.2	2637	1.9	0.8	2.5	14.3	10.7	13.4	0.33
★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	126.1	14881	1.7	1.0	12.3	16.8	14.8	11.9	0.51
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	32.6	731	2.3	0.8	4.7	9.9	11.6	13.1	0.41
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	197.6	3602	1.9	0.9	7.3	12.7	10.6	12.7	0.34
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	59.0	14993	1.7	1.0	11.2	14.4	8.3	11.4	0.28
★	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	92.9	32390	1.5	0.8	7.6	14.2	8.2	12.5	0.22
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	143.9	1045	2.2	1.0	3.1	14.0	11.6	12.9	0.41
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.9	51	2.3	0.9	7.7	12.4	10.0	-	0.32
-	Navi ELSS Tax Saver	27.7	51	2.3	0.4	6.5	10.8	9.5	11.2	0.31
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.3	47	2.3	0.8	6.9	10.1	8.6	-	0.23
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	172.7	72	2.5	1.7	1.7	12.7	12.1	13.7	0.43
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	128.0	19946	1.6	0.5	7.2	17.9	14.5	16.2	0.50
-	Kotak Contra	149.8	5087	1.8	0.6	13.7	19.4	16.0	16.8	0.57
-	SBI Contra	379.2	48729	1.5	0.7	9.0	18.1	19.5	16.8	0.82
EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	52.9	6371	1.8	0.6	12.8	21.4	20.9	17.0	0.89
★★★★	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	136.9	2417	2.1	1.3	4.7	15.5	16.6	16.2	0.78
★★★★	LIC MF Dividend Yield	29.4	662	2.3	0.8	8.4	19.8	15.8	-	0.52
★★★	UTI Dividend Yield	175.9	3800	2.0	1.4	10.2	18.8	16.0	15.1	0.60
★★	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	447.2	1524	2.2	1.4	9.7	18.0	17.9	13.8	0.62
★	Sundaram Dividend Yield	134.4	900	2.3	1.0	9.4	15.3	13.6	15.7	0.51
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	180.0	2521	2.0	0.6	1.3	13.3	14.8	13.2	0.52
★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari India Consumption	29.5	1440	2.1	0.6	3.0	14.3	12.1	-	0.40
★★★★	Canara Robeco Consumer Trends	102.4	1909	2.1	0.8	5.2	14.2	12.5	16.2	0.41
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	201.5	6141	1.8	0.8	5.7	13.4	12.3	14.9	0.41
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	86.1	4386	1.8	0.4	5.1	14.6	14.0	15.8	0.45
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	284.0	2930	2.0	0.9	-0.5	11.8	14.7	14.7	0.49
★★★★	Tata India Consumer	41.0	2532	2.0	0.8	3.0	15.8	13.5	15.9	0.42
★★	Sundaram Consumption	88.2	1461	2.2	1.2	0.7	13.4	11.8	13.4	0.40
★★	UTI India Consumer	54.4	690	2.5	1.6	6.1	13.4	11.2	11.8	0.34
★	Mahli Manu Consumption	21.0	512	2.4	0.7	3.7	13.7	12.2	-	0.40
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
★★★★★	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	105.2	1676	2.1	0.8	15.4	17.4	13.8	16.0	0.43
★★★★	Invesco India Fin Serv	140.6	1628	2.1	0.8	21.6	20.3	15.8	16.6	0.43
★★★★	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	634.6	7753	1.8	1.0	16.9	17.0	14.6	15.4	0.49
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	61.2	3641	2.0	1.0	17.0	15.5	12.1	14.9	0.35
★★★★	ICICI Pru Banking & Fin Serv	130.7	10951	1.8	1.0	12.3	14.2	11.5	15.2	0.37
★★★★	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	44.1	10415	1.8	0.7	22.0	20.1	13.5	17.6	0.40
★★★★	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	43.3	3213	1.9	0.5	17.5	15.9	12.2	16.2	0.31
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	48.4	379	2.4	0.8	16.7	16.5	11.0	13.8	0.37
★★	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	193.9	1425	2.1	1.1	18.6	16.2	12.3	13.2	0.36
★	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	21.2	277	2.5	1.2	17.8	11.5	10.3	10.6	0.30
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	52.9	12	2.5	1.9	12.9	12.0	10.1	14.1	0.29
EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS										
★★★★★	SBI Technology Opport	187.2	5056	1.9	0.9	-7.8	9.0	12.5	15.3	0.37
★★★★	ICICI Pru Technology	170.3	15439	1.7	1.0	-10.8	7.5	10.1	15.5	0.29
★★★	Franklin Ind Technology	448.4	1938	2.1	1.1	-7.6	14.6	10.4	14.9	0.28
★★	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	141.8	4723	1.9	0.8	-13.2	5.4	8.5	15.3	0.26
★	Tata Digital India	39.0	11999	1.7	0.5	-15.7	6.3	9.3	14.5	0.26
EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru P.H.D	38.0	6658	1.9	1.0	8.0	27.1	16.9	-	0.58
★★★★	DSP Healthcare	37.0	2971	1.9	0.7	0.3	20.8	14.2	-	0.44
★★★★	Mirae Asset Healthcare	39.1	2640	1.9	0.5	12.6	24.9	16.0	-	0.50
★★★★	Nippon Ind Pharma	510.7	7875	1.8	0.9	9.0	23.8	15.5	14.0	0.50
★★★★	SBI Healthcare Opport	428.7	3823	1.9	0.9	7.4	25.8	17.1	12.0	0.57
★★	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	29.7	1240	2.1	0.7	7.4	23.6	15.3	11.6	0.49
★	UTI Healthcare	280.3	1107	2.3	1.3	8.5	25.1	15.3	12.1	0.48
-	LIC MF Healthcare	28.5	82	2.4	1.1	5.5	21.9	12.0	-	0.35
HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS										
★★★★★	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	37.5	1329	2.0	0.7	11.4	17.8	17.0	-	0.51
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	398.5	49257	1.5	0.9	12.5	17.9	18.0	16.4	0.93
★★★★★	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	415.2	1958	2.1	0.8	11.4	12.2	15.5	15.6	0.56
★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Aggressive Hybrid	27.4	1243	2.1	0.5	8.1	13.5	11.1	-	0.44
★★★★	Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid	62.7	3453	1.9	0.4	9.3	15.5	14.1	13.1	0.65
★★★★	JM Aggressive Hybrid	113.5	753	2.3	0.8	2.6	15.8	14.1	12.3	0.53
★★★★	Kotak Aggressive Hybrid	62.1	8431	1.7	0.5	12.4	14.4	12.8	13.8	0.55
★★★★	UTI Aggressive Hybrid	401.9	6663	1.9	1.2	8.3	15.5	14.0	13.0	0.65
★★	Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid	26.2	1132	2.1	0.6	14.1	15.4	12.7	-	0.51
★★	Canara Robeco Equity Hybrid	356.7	1664	1.7	0.6	9.9	12.9	10.9	13.1	0.44

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	
CASH FUNDS										
LIQUID FUNDS										
-	360 ONE Liquid	2088.1	1283	0.3	0.2	5.8	5.7	5.7	6.1	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	437.5	51838	0.4	0.2	5.9	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	Axis Liquid	3023.7	43636	0.2	0.1	5.9	5.9	5.9	6.3	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3277.7	17384	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3128.1	1915	0.1	0.1	5.9	6.0	5.9	6.4	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3120.6	12362	0.3	0.1	5.8	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3267.6	7457	0.2	0.1	5.9	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	DSP Liquidity	3876.8	21058	0.2	0.1	5.9	5.9	5.9	6.3	-
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3472.6	10631	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	Groww Liquid	2625.8	164	0.2	0.1	6.0	5.9	5.8	6.3	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5326.5	67850	0.3	0.2	5.8	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2706.4	17735	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	401.8	53738	0.3	0.2	5.7	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3731.4	15423	0.2	0.2	5.7	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	ITI Liquid	1413.1	56	0.3	0.1	5.6	5.5	5.6	6.1	-
-	JM Liquid	74.0	2577	0.3	0.2	5.7	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
-	Kotak Liquid	5485.7	42746	0.3	0.2	5.7	5.7	5.8	6.3	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	4906.5	14187	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1767.0	1145	0.3	0.2	6.0	5.9	5.9	6.3	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2846.4	12395	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.3	1105	0.4	0.2	5.5	5.5	5.5	5.8	-
-	Navi Liquid	29.5	68	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.4	5.5	5.8	6.60
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6624.8	32736	0.3	0.2	5.8	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1505.3	5098	0.2	0.1	5.9	5.8	5.8	6.1	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	353.4	677	0.2	0.1	5.7	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Quant Liquid	42.9	1261	0.5	0.2	5.7	5.6	5.6	6.0	-
-	Quantum Liquid	36.3	567	0.3	0.2	5.5	5.5	5.5	5.9	-
-	SBI Liquid	4241.7	66119	0.3	0.2	5.7	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2392.6	6221	0.4	0.1	5.7	5.6	5.7	6.2	-
-	Tata Liquid	4276.2	33551	0.3	0.2	5.9	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Union Liquid	2612.9	7923	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.9	5.9	6.3	-
-	UTI Liquid	4454.3	27263	0.2	0.1	5.8	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1459.2	600	0.3	0.2	5.8	5.7	5.7	6.2	-
ARBITRAGE FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.6	26736	1.0	0.3	5.5	6.3	6.0	6.3	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.4	8739	1.0	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.1	6.3	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	33.7	8829	1.1	0.4	5.9	6.1	5.8	6.1	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.3	47	0.9	0.4	6.6	6.2	5.8	5.9	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.7	1370	1.1	0.3	5.7	5.9	5.7	6.1	0.00
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.5	6891	1.0	0.4	5.7	6.3	6.0	6.1	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.2	15619	1.1	0.4	5.6	6.2	6.0	6.2	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	31.9	24503	0.9	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.1	6.3	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	19.7	2419	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.3	6.0	6.1	-
-	ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	35.7	32976	0.9	0.4	6.4	6.6	6.1	6.4	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	33.2	28593	1.1	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.2	6.3	0.10
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.5	54	0.9	0.2	7.2	7.0	6.3	6.4	-
-	JM Arbitrage	33.9	376	1.1	0.4	5.5	6.2	5.9	5.8	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.0	71931	1.0	0.4	5.7	6.5	6.1	6.3	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.4	277	1.0	0.3	4.8	6.0	5.8	6.0	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.8	97	1.1	0.4	4.8	6.0	5.7	5.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.5	3639	0.9	0.1	5.6	6.5	6.1	6.0	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.6	16390	1.1	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.1	6.1	1.70
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.0	90	1.0	0.4	5.5	6.0	5.7	5.9	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.2	43574	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.4	6.1	6.4	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.0	355	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.0	6.1	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	14.9	20563	1.1	0.3	5.6	6.5	6.0	6.4	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.6	290	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.0	5.8	5.9	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	36.5	11070	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.2	6.5	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

*****	Aditya Birla SL Savings	571.7	21467	0.6	0.3	7.2	7.4	7.4	6.3	9.89
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1604.1	670	0.5	0.3	6.7	7.0	7.2	6.1	2.25
*****	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4189.0	10672	1.1	0.4	6.6	6.8	6.9	6.7	28.54
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	15.8	3566	0.5	0.3	6.6	7.0	7.1	5.9	-
*****	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	28.8	16816	0.8	0.4	6.9	7.1	7.1	6.1	10.98
*****	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1361.8	1809	0.5	0.2	6.8	7.2	7.2	6.1	1.66
*****	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4401.9	3946	1.0	0.3	6.4	6.7	6.8	6.3	10.88
*****	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.3	5824	1.2	0.4	6.4	6.6	6.7	5.6	8.95
*****	DSP Ultra Short	3532.3	3714	1.0	0.3	6.3	6.6	6.7	5.5	10.16
*****	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.8	17171	0.7	0.4	6.6	7.0	7.0	5.9	4.22
*****	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1408.5	2874	0.3	0.2	6.7	7.0	7.1	6.0	-
*****	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2801.7	1292	0.8	0.2	6.5	6.8	6.9	5.7	11.55
*****	Kotak Savings	44.6	16105	0.8	0.4	6.7	6.9	6.9	5.8	8.20
*****	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1429.4	217	0.7	0.3	6.5	6.9	6.9	5.8	4.38
*****	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6217.7	13685	0.6	0.4	6.7	7.0	7.1	5.9	8.23
*****	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1410.3	541	1.0	0.5	6.0	6.4	6.5	5.4	-
*****	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3278.3	165	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.4	6.4	5.5	6.68
*****	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1370.0	230	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.5	6.4	5.4	2.32
*****	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.3	165	0.9	0.5	6.0	6.4	6.5	5.5	-
*****	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.7	3793	1.2	0.3	6.3	6.6	6.7	5.5	12.54
*****	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3938.7	563	1.0	0.4	6.2	6.5	6.5	5.3	-
*****	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.0	500	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.6	5.7	4.7	-
*****	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2774.5	1907	1.4	0.2	5.6	6.0	6.1	5.0	1.63

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

*****	ICICI Pru Savings	567.8	31284	0.6	0.4	7.5	7.6	7.7	6.4	7.25
*****	UTI Low Duration	3699.5	2990	0.4	0.3	7.3	7.4	7.4	7.3	5.72
*****	Axis Treasury Advantage	3224.5	7831	0.7	0.4	7.2	7.4	7.4	6.2	7.92
*****	DSP Low Duration	20.6	5593	0.6	0.3	6.8	7.0	7.1	5.9	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	60.1	25582	1.1	0.5	7.0	7.1	7.2	6.0	11.02
*****	HSBC Low Duration	29.8	1009	0.9	0.4	8.3	7.8	7.7	6.2	12.61
*****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	681.7	15209	1.2	0.4	6.7	6.8	6.9	5.8	10.10
*****	Bandhan Low Duration	40.1	5927	0.7	0.3	6.8	7.0	7.1	5.9	-
*****	Canara Robeco Savings	43.9	1350	0.5	0.2	7.0	7.1	7.2	5.9	-
*****	Invesco India Low Duration	3934.9	2065	0.7	0.3	6.9	7.1	7.2	5.9	8.36
*****	JM Low Duration	38.5	222	0.9	0.4	6.8	7.0	7.0	5.8	5.62
*****	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3895.3	10969	1.0	0.4	6.9	7.1	7.1	6.0	8.89
*****	SBI Low Duration	3627.3	16391	0.9	0.4	6.7	6.9	7.0	5.7	1.71
*****	Tata Treasury Advantage	4090.0	3491	0.6	0.2	6.9	7.1	7.1	6.0	3.00
*****	Kotak Low Duration	3473.4	16393	1.2	0.4	6.8	7.0	7.0	5.8	10.70
*****	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1697.2	573	1.1	0.3	6.6	6.8	6.9	5.6	15.12
*****	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2346.6	2720	0.9	0.2	6.7	7.0	7.0	5.7	3.32
*****	Sundaram Low Duration	3586.4	470	1.2	0.4	6.4	6.8	6.7	5.7	2.77
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.6	301	1.0	0.3	6.6	6.7	6.8	5.6	5.02
*****	LIC MF Low Duration	41.0	2018	1.2	0.3	6.5	6.7	6.8	5.6	2.58

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Money Market	4326.9	21876	0.4	0.2	7.1	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
*****	UTI Money Market	3216.4	20320	0.2	0.1	7.2	7.4	7.5	6.3	-
*****	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	385.6	30778	0.4	0.2	7.0	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
*****	Axis Money Market	1492.4	23799	0.3	0.2	7.2	7.4	7.5	6.3	-
*****	ICICI Pru Money Market	395.8	35305	0.4	0.2	7.2	7.4	7.5	6.3	-
*****	Kotak Money Market	4682.1	33661	0.4	0.2	7.1	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1436.1	4965	0.4	0.2	7.0	7.1	7.1	5.8	-
*****	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.3	4352	0.3	0.1	7.2	7.3	7.4	6.2	-
*****	HDFC Money Market	5958.6	33094	0.4	0.2	7.1	7.3	7.4	6.2	-
*****	PGIM India Money Market	1380.4	226	0.5	0.2	6.8	7.0	7.1	5.8	-
*****	Sundaram Money Market	15.6	2334	0.3	0.2	7.1	7.2	7.3	6.0	-
*****	Tata Money Market	4922.9	36819	0.4	0.2	7.1	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
*****	DSP Savings	54.8	8549	0.4	0.2	6.7	7.0	7.1	5.9	-
*****	HSBC Money Market	27.5	5379	0.3	0.2	7.0	7.2	7.2	5.8	-
*****	Invesco India Money Market	3171.8	6596	0.4	0.2	6.9	7.1	7.2	5.9	-
*****	SBI Savings	43.1	35418	0.7	0.3	6.8	6.9	7.0	5.8	-
*****	Bandhan Money Market	42.0	14805	0.4	0.1	7.1	7.1	7.0	5.7	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★	Edelweiss Money Market	29.5	3027	0.6	0.1	6.6	6.7	6.7	5.4	-
DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICI Pru Short Term	62.6	22852	1.1	0.5	7.5	7.6	7.7	6.5	10.20
★★★★★	UTI Short Duration	32.9	3090	0.8	0.4	6.9	7.1	7.4	7.1	9.73
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.4	9386	1.0	0.4	7.3	7.5	7.5	6.3	9.99
★★★★★	Axis Short Duration	33.2	11860	0.9	0.4	7.6	7.7	7.6	6.2	8.66
★★★★★	HDFC Short Term Debt	33.3	12721	0.7	0.4	7.5	7.7	7.7	6.4	5.21
★★★★	Nippon Ind Short Duration	54.9	8367	0.9	0.4	7.6	7.7	7.6	6.3	7.92
★★★★	Bandhan Short Duration	59.2	1055	0.8	0.3	6.9	7.3	7.4	5.9	-
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.3	2997	1.1	0.4	7.0	7.2	7.4	5.9	1.70
★★★★	HSBC Short Duration	27.4	4308	0.7	0.3	7.2	7.3	7.3	5.8	-
★★★★	Kotak Bond Short Term	54.0	17568	1.1	0.4	6.9	7.2	7.2	5.9	-
★★★★	Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	580	1.1	0.2	6.8	7.1	7.1	5.7	0.86
★★★★	SBI Short Term Debt	33.4	17213	0.9	0.4	7.3	7.4	7.4	6.0	6.00
★★★★	Sundaram Short Duration	45.9	201	0.7	0.3	6.9	7.3	7.3	6.1	2.50
★★★	Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.2	366	1.0	0.4	6.4	6.7	6.7	5.4	-
★★★	DSP Short Term	48.2	3743	0.9	0.4	6.8	7.1	7.2	5.7	-
★★★	Invesco India Short Duration	3690.6	1064	1.1	0.4	6.9	7.1	7.2	5.6	5.46
★★★	Tata Short Term Bond	49.4	3745	1.2	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.8	5.5	-
★	Growth Short Duration	2152.7	94	1.0	0.3	6.9	6.7	6.5	5.0	-
★	LIC MF Short Duration	15.1	194	1.2	0.4	6.7	6.9	6.9	5.3	5.52
-	Bank of India Short Term Income	27.7	279	1.0	0.5	6.5	7.7	7.3	10.3	2.89
-	Mahi Manu Short Duration	13.2	89	1.3	0.4	6.7	7.1	7.1	5.7	15.65
DEBT - MEDIUM TO LONG DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	UTI Medium to Long Duration	74.6	306	1.6	1.3	5.0	6.2	6.7	8.3	9.86
★★★★★	ICI Pru Bond	41.2	2912	1.0	0.6	5.9	6.9	7.5	6.2	-
★★★★★	SBI Medium to Long Duration	72.1	2085	1.5	0.8	5.2	6.3	7.0	5.8	29.84
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Income	127.3	1966	1.1	0.7	4.6	5.9	6.6	5.8	-
★★★★	Kotak Bond	78.0	1908	1.7	0.7	4.9	6.0	6.7	5.4	-
★★★★	LIC MF Medium to Long Duration	73.9	199	0.5	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.2	5.6	-
★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium to Long Dur	90.9	387	1.5	0.7	4.4	5.7	6.6	5.5	-
★★★	Bandhan Medium to Long Duration	65.6	473	2.0	1.3	4.0	5.1	6.0	4.6	-
★★★	HDFC Income	59.2	856	1.4	0.8	5.0	6.3	6.8	5.1	-
★	Canara Robeco Income	56.1	117	1.9	0.8	4.1	5.3	5.8	4.6	-
DEBT - LONG DURATION FUNDS										
-	ICI Pru Long Term Bond	90.5	977	1.0	0.4	4.0	6.1	7.1	5.3	-
-	Nippon Ind Nivesh Lakshya LD	17.8	8228	0.7	0.3	2.9	5.3	6.9	5.6	-
DEBT - DYNAMIC BOND FUNDS										
★★★★★	360 ONE Dynamic Bond	23.5	626	0.5	0.3	8.1	8.2	8.5	7.1	4.03
★★★★★	UTI Dynamic Bond	31.7	431	1.6	0.8	5.8	6.5	7.0	8.7	-
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Dynamic Bond	47.7	1886	1.2	0.6	6.7	7.2	7.5	6.9	27.12
★★★★★	ICI Pru All Seasons Bond	38.1	14843	1.3	0.6	6.6	7.3	7.5	6.5	20.98
★★★★★	Quantum Dynamic Bond	21.9	102	1.0	0.5	5.8	6.5	7.4	6.3	-
★★★★	Axis Dynamic Bond	30.5	1132	0.6	0.3	7.2	7.3	7.5	6.3	-
★★★★	DSP Strategic Bond	3389.0	885	1.2	0.5	4.0	5.4	7.2	5.7	-
★★★★	HDFC Dynamic Debt	90.8	634	1.4	0.8	4.4	5.9	6.6	6.1	-
★★★★	Kotak Dynamic Bond	38.3	2619	1.3	0.6	5.6	6.4	7.4	5.9	3.62
★★★★	Nippon Ind Dynamic Bond	38.7	4084	0.8	0.4	7.5	7.8	7.9	6.5	-
★★★★	PGIM India Dynamic Bond	2663.3	93	1.7	0.5	4.4	5.8	6.5	5.3	-
★★★★	SBI Dynamic Bond	36.6	4100	1.4	0.6	5.9	6.5	7.4	5.9	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Dynamic Bond	45.9	145	1.7	0.7	3.1	5.3	6.2	5.2	-
★★★	HSBC Dynamic Bond	30.1	132	0.6	0.3	5.1	6.3	6.9	5.5	-
★★★	Mirae Asset Dynamic Bond	16.7	117	1.0	0.1	6.7	6.8	6.8	5.1	-
★★★	Bandhan Dynamic Bond	34.3	229	1.6	0.7	3.8	5.0	6.6	5.2	-
★★★	Canara Robeco Dynamic Bond	29.5	975	1.8	0.7	3.5	4.6	5.5	4.4	-
DEBT - CORPORATE BOND FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICI Pru Corporate Bond	31.1	33237	0.6	0.4	7.5	7.7	7.8	6.6	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Corporate Bond	62.2	8950	0.8	0.4	7.3	7.6	7.8	6.6	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Corporate Bond	116.7	27913	0.5	0.3	6.8	7.4	7.6	6.5	-
★★★★	Axis Corporate Bond	17.7	8588	1.0	0.4	7.4	7.5	7.6	6.2	-
★★★★	Kotak Corporate Bond	3916.0	17275	0.7	0.4	7.3	7.6	7.6	6.3	-
★★★★	Bandhan Corporate Bond	19.9	14250	0.7	0.3	6.9	7.2	7.2	5.9	-
★★★★	Franklin Ind Corporate Debt	103.8	1350	0.7	0.3	8.8	8.2	7.8	6.3	6.70
★★★★	HDFC Corporate Bond	33.6	33200	0.6	0.4	6.8	7.4	7.6	6.3	-
★★★★	Invesco India Corporate Bond	3287.8	6099	0.7	0.3	7.0	7.4	7.4	5.9	-
★★★★	SBI Corporate Bond	16.1	22518	0.8	0.4	7.3	7.4	7.4	6.0	-
★★★★	Sundaram Corporate Bond	41.5	627	0.6	0.3	7.0	7.3	7.1	6.0	-
★★★★	UTI Corporate Bond	17.0	5532	0.6	0.3	7.3	7.4	7.5	6.1	-

Iran conflict can hit harder than Ukraine war: Stubb

BUTTERFLY EFFECT. ‘West Asia conflict is impacting global trade, energy prices’

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

The economic implications of the war US/Israel-Iran war could actually be much bigger than the Ukraine war, Finland’s President Alexander Stubb said on Saturday.

Stubb was participating in a fireside chat at the Finland India business summit in Mumbai.

Stubb said the Iran war has turned into a regional conflict. Just as the Russia-Ukraine war impacted food and fertilizer production, the West Asia conflict is impacting trade and energy prices.

“I don’t think we have even begun to grapple with what will be the economic implications of this war. It could actually



Finland is the least corrupt country in the world and so it’s a very stable place to do business in

ALEXANDER STUBB
President of Finland



be much bigger than implication of the Russia-Ukraine war,” he said.

STRATEGIC TIES

Stubb, who was on a three-day state visit to India, said that Finland always tries to mediate and find peaceful solutions to war. “For us the key war to end is between Russia and Ukraine,” he said.

During Stubb’s visit India and Finland decided to elevate bilateral partnership to a strategic partnership on digitalisation and sustainability. The two countries signed 11 MoUs and decided to double the current \$3 billion annual trade by 2030.

Stubb said Finland has a strong focus on mobile networks, quantum,

satellite, space, circular economy and there are lot of possibilities to grow collaboration between the two countries.

“Finland is the least corrupt country in the world and so it’s a very stable place to do business in,” he stated.

DOCK UPGRADE

Earlier in the day, an MoU was signed between Maharashtra Fisheries Development Corporation and Finnish companies for modernisation of Mumbai’s Sassoon Dock. Under the agreement, Finnish companies will support energy-efficient lighting systems, AI-based surveillance solutions, as well as initiatives for recycling fishing nets and promoting health and sanitation awareness.

Govt asks ports to store Gulf-bound cargo as ships avoid West Asia waters

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Union Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways has asked ports to permit storage of goods destined for West Asia as transshipment cargo.

The move is expected to help global shipping lines which have decided to abandon sailings to Strait of Hormuz and of-flood containers at available ports.

SOP ISSUED

The Ministry on Friday issued an SOP (standard operating procedure) for ports to handle the situation and mitigate the impact of the West Asia conflict.

Ports have been asked to allot additional storage area if required for storing such cargo during the conflict period. They have also been instructed to facilitate berthing of *ad hoc* vessels for pick up and drop of transshipment cargo bound for Middle East.

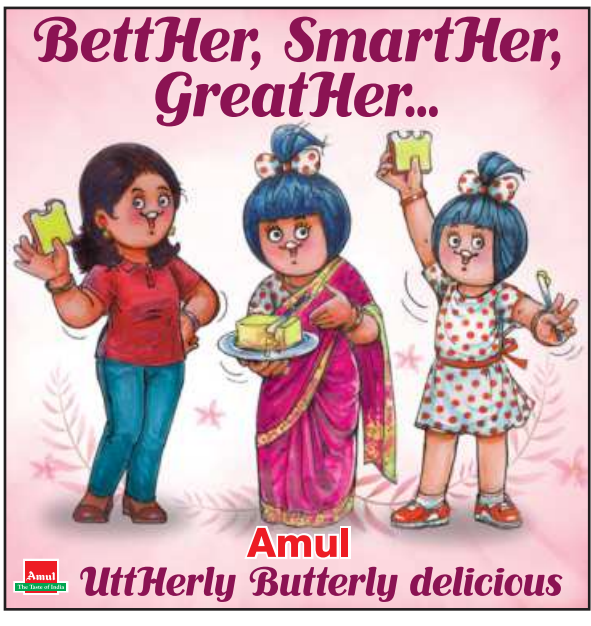
Instructions have also been issued to ports to provide prior-

ity handling for perishables. “Ports shall co-ordinate closely with relevant agencies such as Customs, Director-General of Foreign Trade and other authorities for implementation of the measures,” the SOP said.

“Ports may consider requests from users regarding reduction, waiver or remission (such as reefer plugging charges, storage rent, change of vessel charges, etc) on a case-to-case basis depending upon prevailing circumstances at the port,” it added.

Shipping major Mediterranean Shipping Company has declared “end of voyage” for Gulf-bound shipments amid the Iran-Israel conflict.

A spokesperson for German shipping line Hapag-Lloyd said the disruption is forcing carriers to identify multiple alternative locations. “Some ports are closed or cannot be reached. Different ports need to be identified to store these containers until they can be transported to their final destinations,” the spokesperson added.



‘Gold price to rise as central banks diversify into non-dollar reserves’

Our Bureau
Mumbai

As central banks continue to diversify into non-dollar reserves, with a marked increase in their gold holdings, the gold price is expected to rise further, per an assessment by SBI’s Economic Research Department. It also hinted that central banks, especially the US Fed, may go in for gold reserve revaluation as a quick fix for the national debt burden.

Since end-August 2025, international gold prices have increased 47.6 per cent to \$5,092/ounce on March 6 from \$3448 on August 29, 2025.

“Central banks are shifting away from treasuries to gold holdings. The transition happened in June 2025 for the first time since 1996”

“Gold as a percentage of total reserves has risen to as much as 80.4 per cent for the US and Germany, followed by 79.4 per cent for Italy... India has around 17.6 per cent of its reserves in the form of gold,” said SBI economists.

DEBT REDUCTION

Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Advisor, SBI, said that an unorthodox attempt that could emerge in

the long run is the US revaluing the Federal government’s 261.5 million troy ounces in gold reserves from a statutory price of \$42.22 per troy ounce to current market rates.

The corresponding revaluation reserves would create a massive jump in assets first, from current \$11 billion value to \$1.3 trillion, almost 4 per cent plus of US GDP, wiping 70 per cent of US budget deficit. This can be quick fix to the US’ astronomical debt burden, currently at \$38.8 trillion, Ghosh said.

SBI Research noted that the US Bitcoin Act Sec 9(c) also stipulates that the Treasury Secretary would revalue gold at market price to purchase one million Bitcoin.

“With the rise in gold price, the value of reserves on central bank balance sheets increases dramatically. When central banks revalue their gold holdings, the increased value is reflected as an asset, and often simultaneously increases liabilities to balance the books,” it added.

They opined that even though recalibrating the Fed’s gold holdings would enhance its balance-sheet (though not reduce its debt directly), a general consensus is more assets should improve America’s fiscal flexibility.

Centre mulls coconut oil distribution via ration shops instead of palm oil to benefit farmer, users

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Union government is considering the distribution of coconut oil instead of palm oil through the public distribution system (PDS) to ensure farmers get a better price, Union Minister of Agriculture and Farmers’ Welfare said on Saturday.

The Coconut Development Board has written to State Governments on the distribution of coconut oil through PDS or ration shops. He told the media after a stakeholders’ meeting with coconut growers, scientists, and industry representatives

that substituting coconut oil for palm oil in the PDS would not only provide a stable market and better prices for farmers but also offer healthier options to consumers.

“Coconut oil should be provided in the PDS instead of other oils. If we promote coconut oil in the PDS, it will benefit the farmers. We will discuss this further with the State governments,” said Chouhan.

NEW VARIETIES

The government is placing special emphasis on developing new, advanced and disease-resistant coconut varieties to improve its

productivity and quality, Chouhan said.

This will help strengthen India’s position in the global coconut export market, he told a post-Budget discussion in Chennai.

Stating that extensive discussions are being held with farmers, scientists and experts so that practical and effective solutions can be developed collectively, he said these post-Budget consultations are necessary to ensure that policy measures remain grounded in the real experiences and needs of farmers.

The government is fine-tuning details of the coconut promotion scheme in con-



Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers’ Welfare Shriyaji Singh Chouhan **BIJOY GHOSH**

sultation with farmers and State governments. “Once these discussions are completed, a comprehensive framework related to the

Coconut Promotion Board will also be prepared,” he said.

The aim of this framework will be to create a strong institutional structure that can guide and support the development of the coconut sector in the coming years, said Chouhan.

The coconut promotion scheme announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi will promote production, processing and intercropping, which will help in increasing the income of growers.

In particular, the Agriculture Minister said that nearly 28 per cent of farmers in Tamil Nadu are expected to

benefit from the implementation of the proposed measures and initiatives relating to coconut development.

SENILE PLANTS

Pointing out that many coconut plantations in the country are over 60 years old, leading to a decline in productivity, he said that diseases such as root wilt and white fly are also affecting coconut output.

“These challenges require coordinated efforts and innovative solutions to ensure that farmers can maintain productivity and improve their income levels,” said Chouhan.

130 Maoists surrender before Telangana CM

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

In a major development, 130 Maoists, including top leaders, surrendered before Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy along with their weapons.

The Maoists included three State committee members, one regional committee member, 10 divisional committee

members, 46 members of the area committee and 70 other members.

They also handed over 124 weapons including LMGs and AK-47 rifles. The Chief Minister said the State government would quash the cases against them within the available legal framework.

Appreciating the police, Revanth Reddy called upon other top leaders including Ganapathi, to also surrender.

SBI launches exclusive \$500 m loan facility for women empowerment

Our Bureau
Mumbai

State Bank of India on Saturday said it has launched a \$500 million syndicated Social Term Loan facility, focussed exclusively on women empowerment, with a greenshoe option.

The syndicated transaction, first of its kind by SBI, is aimed at supporting gender equality and inclusive economic growth, and is expected to be the largest

gender-themed loan globally, India’s largest bank said in a statement.

This transaction, which is dedicated to advancing women empowerment initiatives across India, is a milestone for SBI and the global ESG (Environmental, Social and Governance) financing landscape, per the statement. It is focussed on accelerating social impact and demonstrates SBI’s commitment to reducing “the gender gap.”



SBI Chairman Challa Sreenivasulu Setty

The bank said the financing also contributes meaningfully to UN’s Sustainable

State Bank said the financing also contributes meaningfully to UN’s Sustainable Development Goal 5

Development Goal 5 — ‘Achieve Gender Equality and Empower all Women and Girls’.

SBI Chairman C S Setty

said, “On this women’s day... This landmark social loan embodies our dedication to Environmental, Social, and Governance principles, with a sharp focus on creating opportunities for women. We believe that true progress depends not only on economic growth but also on our ability to drive positive social change, empower women and build an inclusive society for all stakeholders.”

MUFG is the original Mandated Lead Arranger,

Underwriter and Book-runner and sole social loan co-ordinator for the transaction, the bank said.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liability in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

Beyond the canvas: Women ‘drawing’ Delhi’s art space

How women gallerists are taking creative punts to run profitable spaces

Chitra Narayanan
New Delhi

Varanasi’s ghats look incandescent through the brush strokes of prolific painter Paresh Maity. The smallest of details are captured with luminous intensity in his larger-than-life canvases on display at the Bikaner House in Delhi. The spectacular exhibition also marks the 25th anniversary of Sunaina Anand’s Art Alive Gallery which has had a long association with Maity.

Anand is just one of the many women gallery owners who have made Delhi’s art scene throb with life and helped fetch artists handsome commissions. A few months ago at Bikaner House, Renu Modi celebrated 35 years of her Gallery Espace with a nostalgic exhibition Memory Fields featuring art works by M F Husain and Manjit Bawa among others.

Besides Anand and Modi, there is Bhavna Kakar’s Latitude 28 celebrating its 15th year that started with the intention of breaking the white cube mould and



Renu Modi of Gallery Espace

making the gallery a space for dialogue and experimentation. Then there is Pooja Sood’s Khoj Studios, which is a radical space for alternative art. Roshni Vadehra leads one of Delhi’s oldest art galleries, founded by her father.

And, of course, there is the formidable queen bee of art patronage Kiran Nadar whose KNMA galleries in Saket and Noida have made globally renowned works accessible to the general public. For instance, last year KNMA showed Caravaggio’s rediscovered 400-year-old Baroque masterpiece ‘Mary Magdalene in Ecstasy’ — a truly memor-



Sunaina Anand of Art Alive Gallery

able experience for art lovers.

CURATED VALUE

It’s not easy to run an art gallery. As Anand said, “There are no short-term gains in this field. There are challenges in running an art gallery especially when you want to position your gallery as a strong cultural institution and not just a place to buy and sell art. You have to be very sure about your gallery’s vision and select artists whose art practices align with that programming.” She added that “Legal procedures pertaining to sales and logistics also pose challenges.”



Bhavna Kakar of Latitude 28

“One of the biggest challenges is the unpredictability of the art market,” points out Kakar, as she explains, “Running a gallery can be profitable, but it is rarely a straightforward commercial enterprise.”

“Most galleries operate at the intersection of culture, patronage, and business, and profitability often depends on a combination of sales, relationships, programming, and long-term reputation,” she added.

CHANGING SCENE

But the good news is that the art landscape is changing, Modi said. When she opened her art gallery in

1989, there were only a handful of collectors buying art. “There are many more collectors now, and they are much younger — in their 40s and 50s, or even younger. Awareness levels have risen manifold whether because of social media, or the many art fairs and biennales that have started recently. People building new homes now work with their architects and interior designers to source and display art. Even corporates are buying or commissioning art for their offices,” she added.

Kakar describes how galleries today are also expanding their role beyond exhibitions — through publications, residencies, talks, performances, and collaborations with museums and cultural institutions. “Ultimately, the sustainability of a gallery often lies in its ability to build trust, its long-term vision... When that ecosystem is strong, financial stability tends to follow, even if profitability is rarely the sole motivation for running a gallery,” she added.

Meesho to contest ₹1,500 crore IT demand for AY2023-24

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Meesho said it will contest an income tax demand it has received for about ₹1,500 crore for the assessment year (AY) 2023-24, the e-commerce marketplace said in a stock exchange filing on Saturday.

According to the filing, the Assessment Unit of the Income Tax Department issued an assessment order under Section 143(3) of the Income-tax Act, 1961, along with a demand notice under Section 156. The order raises a total tax demand of

₹1,499.73 crore, including applicable interest. The company said it is evaluating the assessment order and does not agree with the observations and adjustments made by the tax authorities, and “believes that it has adequate legal and factual grounds to contest the same.” Meesho said in the filing, adding that it is taking necessary steps to protect its interests.

The company also pointed out that a similar tax demand had been issued for the previous assessment year (2022-23). The Karnataka High Court had granted an interim stay on the demand notice on April 17, 2025. The

matter remains pending before the court.

Meesho said the latest assessment order and demand notice are not expected to have any major impact on the company’s financial position, operations or other business activities.

DEC QUARTER LOSS

The tax notice on the heels of the company reporting a sharp increase in loss in the December quarter. Meesho’s Q3 net loss widened nearly 12-fold to ₹491 crore up from ₹37.4 crore in the same period last year, even as the revenue rose 32 per cent to ₹3,517.6 crore.

JAIPUR METRO RAIL CORPORATION LIMITED
1st Floor, Administrative Building, Metro Depot, Bhriqga Path, Mansarovar, Jaipur 302020
Tel. No. 0141-2822111 (O), E-mail: gmtem@jaipurmetrorail.in

No. : JMRC/O&S/EL/2025-26/NIB/021

Date : 05/03/2026

NOTICE INVITING BID

JMRC invites bids from the eligible contractors/suppliers for "Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of X-BIS Machine (Model No: RAP-620XR) for Five Years installed at Nine Metro Stations of JMRC Phase-1A." With estimated cost ₹ 2,29,14,407 (including GST). Scheduled Last Date and Time for Online Submission of Bids is 30.03.2026 by 15:00 Hrs. Please visit JMRC website <https://transport.raajasthan.gov.in/jmrc>, SPPR Portal <https://sppr.raajasthan.gov.in> or <https://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in> for all Corrigendum/clarification/addendum.

(UBN No. JMRS25GSL0800159)
Bidding Starts: 05/03/2026

Director (O&S)

प्रधान निदेश, सर्वोच्च एवं आकाशवाणी सचिव - जयपुर मेट्रो

the hindu

businessline.

Classifieds

RENTAL

RESIDENTIAL

MOGAFFAIR

2300 SQFT 3BHK | FLR CC Amenities
NR DAV Boys Sch 9150268143

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

